



DPIR
DEPARTMENT OF POLITICS &
INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

COMPARATIVE GOVERNMENT

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University of Oxford
Department of Politics and
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COMPARATIVE GOVERNMENT 201

CONTENTS

TEACHING	3
LECTURES IN COMPARATIVE GOVERNMENT	4
THEORY AND EMPIRICS OF THE COMPARATIVE METHOD	6
STATE FORMATION AND STATE BUILDING	12
COLONIALISM	16
DEMOCRATIZATION	199
AUTOCRACIES AND HYBRID REGIMES	24
POLITICAL PARTIES AND PARTY SYSTEMS	27
ELECTORAL SYSTEMS	32
EXECUTIVES	39
LEGISLATURES	43
FEDERALISM	49
JUDICIARIES	54
INTEREST GROUPS	59
CLIENTELISM	64
DEMOCRATIC OUTCOMES	68
CONSTITUTIONS	72
ESSAY GUIDE	76

TEACHING

Course Provider

Mihail Chiru (DPIR)

Please contact the course provider with any enquiries about teaching for this paper.

Other Teachers

Many other tutors teach the paper. They are listed on the staff pages of Canvas.



Syllabus

See Canvas and the formal syllabus in the *Examination Decrees and Regulations* for the paper/course description.

Lectures in Comparative Government

*Examination Schools, Mondays, 12 noon. **Please check CANVAS and emails for any updates and changes.** Please note that the lecture list does not follow the same order as the reading list.*

Michaelmas Term

- Week 1 Theoretical and Methodological Principles – Matthew Williams
- Week 2 Democratization – Jody La Porte
- Week 3 Autocracies & Hybrid Regimes – Jody La Porte
- Week 4 Colonialism – Robin Harding
- Week 5 Electoral Systems – Alexander Yeandle
- Week 6 Constitutions – Matthew Williams
- Week 7 Federalism – Paul Martin
- Week 8 Executives – Mihail Chiru

Hilary Term

- Week 1 Courts - Matthew Williams
- Week 2 Parties and Party Systems – Tarik Abou-Chadi
- Week 3 Legislatures – Radoslaw Zubek
- Week 4 Clientelism – Ezequiel Gonzalez-Ocantos
- Week 5 Democratic Outcomes – Robin Harding
- Week 6 State Formation – Neil Ketchley
- Week 7 Interest Groups – Alexander Kuo
- Week 8 No Lecture – Hold for possible rescheduled lecture

How to use this Reading List

This updated reading list is designed for ease of use. Readings are highlighted by a number of stars. Two star works (**) are considered extremely important for tutorial preparation, one star works (*) are highly recommended. Other readings are recommended and might provide additional useful content and ideas for the topic. Given time constraints, sample as many of those readings without a star as possible. You should aim to work your way through a good portion of the reading list on a given topic for the examination. Consult with your individual tutor regarding tutorial preparation as tutors may wish to emphasize additional readings. Lectures will summarize vital points and provide an overview of the topic. Attendance is important for organizing material either prior to or after tutorials.

The reading list includes textbook level readings at the start of each topic. These should be used as an overall introduction to the topic, and as a supplement to the more detailed analyses offered in other books and articles.

For most books the Social Science Library shelf mark is listed in the Library of Congress format. The reading list also includes hyperlinks to as much of the content as possible. For books if you click on the **[SOLO]** tabs you can check shelf marks and availability for all library holdings in the University. For articles the **[Online]** links take you to the 'Find it @ Oxford' page corresponding to the article. Bear in mind that for some of the hyperlinked content you will need to be either connected to the Oxford network, or be connected via VPN if outside of Oxford. Also the

COMPARATIVE GOVERNMENT 201

hyperlinks may not work when the reading list is in a PDF format. Some articles will not have an online link but should be available online via SOLO. Whether an article or book is hyperlinked, or has a short description in the reading list, is not related to its importance; consult as well with your tutor about which readings to emphasize.

Special thanks for the preparation and editing of the reading list goes to Matthew Williams, the lecturers each year, and DPIR and college faculty who provide collective input.



THEORY AND EMPIRICS OF THE COMPARATIVE METHOD

Introduction

The study of comparative government requires careful analysis of the method of comparison. Without this epistemological reflection scholars cannot communicate with confidence the inferences they draw. Therefore the most successful students in this paper can base their arguments on a solid epistemological foundation that makes clear the theoretical and empirical basis for their contentions. This topic covers the key debates about how one should test arguments made in comparative politics and government. The comparative method involves different approaches to testing which hypotheses about cross-national or temporal variation are most plausible.

Essay Questions

- 'Only small-N studies can be detailed enough to attain real understanding of complex political systems.' Discuss.
- 'Since we cannot simulate experimental designs when we study the institutional features of countries, the science of comparative politics is practically impossible.' Discuss.

Readings

Introduction to the Comparative Method

Foundational Readings

The readings here raise important questions about what it means to do social science—questions that continue to be debated today. What is the goal of political science? What does it mean to do social science, and how does it differ (or not) from natural sciences? Is social 'science' possible, and if so how?

- **Roberts Clark, W., Golder, M. and Golder, S. (2013) *Principles of Comparative Politics*. (Washington DC: CQ Press) Ch 2. If consulting other editions, read the chapter 'What is Science?' **JF51.CLA**

SOLO

- Mill, J.S., (1875) *A System of Logic, 9th ed* (London: Longmans, Green, Reader, and Dyer).
 - John Stuart Mill developed the Methods of Agreement and Difference (along with three other lesser known methods) in this book. Mill required this epistemological foundation for his moral and political philosophy, and he drew from the work of David Hume and others by stressing the centrality of induction to make causal propositions. Such propositions are inferential (rather than deductive) and contingent on the assumption that there is no reason to believe that in the future the same causal patterns will persist.

SOLO

Online

- Teune, H. and Przeworski, A. (2000[1970]) *The Logic of Comparative Social Inquiry*, (New York: John Wiley and Sons) esp. Chapters 1-3. **H62.PRZ**
 - Teune and Przeworski revisit Mill to demonstrate the need for making comparative inquiry systematic. Their main argument can be summarized as follows: "People are people wherever you find them" [and thus] "[t]ry to substitute country names with structural or institutional factors." In the prologue

(page xi) of the original version (1970), Przeworski and Teune already predict that “the advent of formal theory will revolutionize social science anew.”

SOLO

- **King, G., Keohane, R. and Verba, S. (1994) *Designing Social Inquiry: Scientific Inference in Qualitative Research* (Princeton: Princeton UP). Ch 1-3. **H61.KIN**
 - Popularly known as ‘KKV’ or ‘DSI’, this became a tremendously influential work because it aimed to set out for the first time a common standard for theory construction and empirical testing in political science. It is aimed at researchers, but it will help you to evaluate the theory that you will encounter in the readings set for this course. On theory see esp Chs. 1-3.

SOLO

- **Brady, H.E. and Collier, D. (2004) *Rethinking Social Inquiry: Diverse Tools, Shared Standards* (Oxford: Rowman and Littlefield) Ch 1. **H62.RET**
 - This book is a direct response to the case made by KKV as Brady and Collier critique the ‘Quantitative Template’ as the basis for all social science research design. Chapter 11 is given over to KKV, allowing them to justify ‘What We Tried To Do’.

SOLO

Online

- *Almond, G. and S. Genco. 1977. “Clouds, Clocks, and the Study of World Politics,” in *World Politics*, 29(4): 489-522

Quantitative versus Qualitative Approaches

A main methodological cleavage is between researchers using quantitative and qualitative approaches. As you do the readings in this section, consider the following questions: What does it mean to do qualitative versus quantitative research? What are the pros/cons and assumptions of each? Does the prospect of ‘mixed method’ research offer a solution? Consider what (a) definitions of a ‘case’; (b) what is a mechanism and why does it matter; (c) the role of counterfactuals, selection bias, and negative cases.

- *King, G., Keohane, R. and Verba, S. 1994. *Designing Social Inquiry: Scientific Inference in Qualitative Research* (Princeton UP). Chapters 1-3.
- *Brady, H.E. and Collier, D. (2004) *Rethinking Social Inquiry: Diverse Tools, Shared Standards* (Oxford: Rowman and Littlefield) esp Ch 1. **H62.RET**
- George, A.L. and Bennett, A. (2005) *Case Studies and Theory Development in the Social Sciences* (Cambridge MA: MIT Press) (Chapter 1: ‘Case Studies and Theory Development’) **H61.GEO**

SOLO

- Gerring J. (2007) *Case Study Research: Principles and Practices* (Cambridge: CUP) (Chapter 3: ‘What is a Case Study Good For?’) **H62.GER**

SOLO

- *Sekhon, J. (2004) ‘Quality Meets Quantity: Case Studies, Conditional Probability, and Counterfactuals.’ *Perspectives on Politics*, 4, 281-93.
 - Sekhon uses a famous example from the study of revolutions and state building to show that one should use Mills methods taking into consideration that causal

relationships are probabilistic, rather than deterministic. He illustrates how this principle applies to both small- and large-N studies.

Online

- *Thomas, G. (2005) 'The Qualitative Foundations of Political Science Methodology', *Perspectives on Politics*, 3(4), 855-866.
- Slater, D. and Ziblatt, D. (2013) 'The enduring indispensability of the controlled comparison', *Comparative Political Studies*, 46(10), 1301-1327. ^[L]_{SEP}
- Mahoney, James and Gary Goertz (2006) "A Tale of Two Cultures: Contrasting Quantitative and Qualitative Research," *Political Analysis* 2006.
- *McKeown, T.J. (2004) 'Case Studies and the Limits of the Quantitative Worldview', in Brady, H.E. and Collier, D. (2004) *Rethinking Social Inquiry: Diverse Tools, Shared Standards* (Oxford: Rowman and Littlefield) **H62.RET**

Experimental Approaches

Recent research in comparative government has used techniques to try to identify causal effects or to test theories in a causal fashion. With this has come a focus on our ability to establish causality, with experimentalists claiming to offer the "gold standard" in causal inference, and others taking issue with this claim. What are the pros/cons of observational versus experimental approaches? Is one inherently better, and if so why? Do experiments solve the problems that supposedly exist in observational work?

- *Samii, Cyrus (2016) "Causal Empiricism in Quantitative Research," *Journal of Politics*, 78(3).
- *Grossman, Guy and Laura Paler (2015) "Using Experiments to Study Political Institutions" in *Handbook of Comparative Political Institutions*. London: Routledge
- Deaton, Angus (2020) "Randomization in the Tropics Revisited: A Theme and Eleven Variations," NBER Working Paper. <http://www.nber.org/papers/w27600>
- *Kubinec, Robert (2020) "Getting Off the Gold Standard for Causal Inference," Unpublished working paper. <https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/a492b>

On Theoretical Approaches to Methods

- *Munck, G. (2007) 'The Past and Present of Comparative Politics', in Gerardo Munck and Richard Snyder eds., *Passion, Craft and Method in Comparative Politics* (The John Hopkins University Press: Baltimore) 32-59 **JF130.MUN**
 - This chapter gives a useful overview of the development of theory and methods in the discipline that will help you to categorize the contributions to the literature on the different topics you studied.

SOLO

- Levi, M. (2009) 'Reconsiderations of Rational Choice in Comparative and Historical Analysis' in Lichbach, M.I. and Zuckerman, A. eds. *Comparative Politics: Rationality, Culture and Structure 2nd ed.* (Cambridge: CUP) Ch 5. **JA86.COM**

- There are several useful chapters in this book, but Levi's chapter in particular stands out as an introduction to rational choice approaches in comparative politics.

SOLO

- *Rodden, J. (2009) 'Back to the Future: Endogenous Institutions and Comparative Politics' in Lichbach, M.I. and Zuckerman, A. eds. *Comparative Politics: Rationality, Culture and Structure 2nd ed.* (Cambridge: CUP). **JA86.COM**
 - Sustained attention to endogeneity as a basic challenge to attempts to theorize and examine the 'effects of institutions' is becoming more widespread in comparative politics. This chapter offers a good introduction to the problem using the example of electoral systems and their effects.

SOLO

- Geddes, B. (2003) *Paradigms and Sand Castles: Theory Building and Research Design in Comparative Politics* (Ann Arbor, Michigan: University of Michigan Press) Ch 1, 1-26. **JA86.GED**
 - This book is aimed at researchers. Although your task for this paper is to evaluate rather than to design research, this book will be useful, because it aims to set out a standard with respect to the role of theory in political research. Reading this book will be very useful in writing your Q-step essay for this paper.

SOLO

- Katznelson, I. (2009) 'Strong Theory, Complex History: Structure and Configuration in Comparative Politics Revisited' in Lichbach, M.I. and Zuckerman, A., eds., *Comparative Politics: Rationality, Culture and Structure 2nd ed.* (Cambridge: CUP) Ch 4. **JA86.COM**

SOLO

- Ross, M.H. (2009) 'Culture in Comparative Political Analysis' in Lichbach, M.I. and Zuckerman, A. eds. *Comparative Politics: Rationality, Culture and Structure 2nd ed.* (Cambridge: CUP) Ch 6. **JA86.COM**

SOLO

Institutionalism

These readings consider the various institutionalist theories that assume that the rules of political interactions among actors are important units of analysis.

- *Hall, P.A. and Taylor, R.C.R. (1996) 'Political Science and the Three New Institutionalisms' *Political Studies*, 44(5), 936–957.

Online

- March, J.G. and Olsen, J.P. (1989) *Rediscovering Institutions: The Organizational Basis of Politics* (Oxford: Maxwell Macmillan)
 - This is a seminal work in the field of 'new institutionalism' where institutions were 'rediscovered' as important units of analysis in political science. Unlike the thick description of the 'old institutionalism' of the turn of the 20th Century, 'new institutionalism' is more analytical and seeks to propose and test complex causal mechanisms concerning institutions in terms of their origins, classification and effects.

SOLO

- Thelen, K. (June 1999) 'Historical Institutionalism in Comparative Politics', *Annual Review of Political Science*, 2, 369-404.
 - This paper outlines historical institutionalism and shows how it is many ways closer to rational choice institutionalism than is commonly accepted. Although she does show the points of divergence as well.

Online

Two classic introductions to rational choice institutionalism with a comparative focus:

- Weingast, B.R. (2002) 'Rational Choice Institutionalism.' *Political Science: The State of the Discipline*. Ira Katznelson and Helen Milner eds. (Norton Press) 661-692.

SOLO

- Shepsle, K. (1989) 'Studying Institutions: Some Lessons from the Rational Choice Approach.' *Journal of Theoretical Politics*, 131-49.

Online

Discursive Institutionalism

- Schmidt, V. (2008) 'Discursive Institutionalism: The Explanatory Power of Ideas and Discourse', *Annual Review of Political Science*, 11, 303-326.
 - Several sub-disciplines of the 'new institutionalism' school have emerged since the 1980s, and some very exciting new work looks at the connections between institutions as well as the institutions themselves. In this work Vivien Schmidt presents a compelling case for the importance of discursive connections and networks in organising and executing power.

Online

Culture, Institutions and their Historical Legacies

- Posner, D. (2004) 'The Political Salience of Cultural Differences: Why Chewas and Tumbukas are Allies in Zambia and Adversaries in Malawi.' *American Political Science Review*, 98, 529-546.
 - A classic study on the underlying political incentives driving ethnic polarization

Online

Summing up empirical approaches in comparative government

- **Laitin, D.D. (2002) 'Comparative Politics: The State of the Subdiscipline', in Katznelson, I. and Milner, H.V. eds. *Political Science: State of the Discipline* (New York: W.W.Norton) 630-659. **JC11.POL**
 - Laitin argues that no method is sufficient on its own, and that we should combine statistical, narrative, and formal modelling techniques.

SOLO

- Thomas, G. (2005) 'The Qualitative Foundations of Political Science Methodology', *Perspectives on Politics*, 3(4), 855-866.
 - This is a review of several important recent contributions, several of which are critical of the approach advocated by KKV.

Online

- *Przeworski, A. (2004) 'Is the Science of Comparative Politics Possible?', in Boix, C. and Stokes, S. (2007) *The Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics* (Oxford: Oxford University Press), 147-71.
 - This chapter provides a pessimistic view on the extent to which it is possible to draw causal inferences in comparative politics, due to the fact that in this subfield we are predominantly interested in questions that can only be addressed with observational data.

Online

STATE FORMATION AND STATE BUILDING

Introduction

This topic aims at extending your understanding in the most fundamental political unit, the modern state. Whereas in Prelims you mainly classified states in terms of their strength, here we will delve more into the origins of states, their historical roots and their development. We will discuss functionalist, Marxist and other political economy theories of why some states succeed whereas others fail to maintain societal order. Looking at different waves of state formation, we will also try to unpack the consequences of institutional heterogeneity in the performance of modern states. For example, we will examine the differences between European and African states in terms of their origins and their institutional performance.

Not all states endure over time. Some of them die out. What explains state failure around the world? We will address this question looking more thoroughly the conditions that determine a state's capacity to survive under domestic and international pressure.

Essay Questions

- What explains heterogeneity in the form and timing of the creation of early state institutions?
- Is violence a necessary condition to create enduring states?

Readings

Text book level introduction to the topic

- **Spruyt, H. (2007) 'War, Trade and State Formation' in Boix, C. and Stokes, S., (2007) *The Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics* (Oxford: Oxford University Press), 211-35.
 - An overview of theories of state, using as a departure point the European experience.

Online

- Vincent, A. (1987) *Theories of the State*, (Basingstoke: McMillan). **JC325.VIN**
 - A introduction to the nature of the state, following the different theoretical approaches in political science: absolutist, constitutional, ethical, class and pluralist.

SOLO

- Dryzek, J. and Dunleavy, P. (2009) *Theories of the Democratic State*, (Basingstoke: McMillan). **JC423.DRY**
 - An updated discussion on the nature of the state, which builds on the developments generated by the global economic crisis.

SOLO

Theories of State Formation

The following texts discuss different explanations of state formation.

- **Tilly, C. (1985) 'War making and state making as organized crime', in Evans, P., Rueschemeyer, D. and Skocpol, T. *Bringing the State Back In* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Ch. 5. **H97.BRI**
 - Arguing against social contract theories, Tilly provides an authoritative account of the formation of modern states as the continuation of organized military forces.

SOLO

- **Centeno, M.A. (1997) 'Blood and Debt: War and Taxation in Nineteenth-century Latin America.' *American Journal of Sociology*, 102(6).
 - Centeno challenges the idea that wars led to state formation in Latin America, pointing to historically prior organizational factors that political authority to social forces.

Online

- *Levi, M. (1981) 'The predatory theory of rule.' *Politics and Society*, 10(4), 431-65.
 - Combining elements from Weberian, Marxist and neoclassical theories of the state, Levi builds a parsimonious bargaining theory of state formation and autonomy.

Online

- Mann, M. (1994) 'The autonomous power of the state: its origins, mechanisms and results.' *European Journal of Sociology* 25: 185-213.
 - Mann introduces the despotic and infrastructural form of state autonomy, both stemming from a territorially-centralized form of organization.

Online

- Tilly, C. (1990) *Coercion, Capital, and European States, AD 990 1990* (Cambridge, Mass.: B. Blackwell) Chs 1, 3, 5 and 6. **JN94.A2.TIL**
 - Tilly's classic study on how the modern state apparatus (bureaucracies, judiciaries, treasuries etc) has its origins in effective war preparation.

SOLO

- **Spruyt, H. (2002) 'The Origins, Development, and Possible Decline of the Modern State.' *Annual Review of Political Science*, 5:127-4.
 - The article tries to examine the limits of classic theories of state formation in their explanation of why and how contemporary states emerge or wither out of new supranational organizations.

Online

- **Olson, M. (1997) 'Dictatorship, Democracy, and Development' *American Political Science Review*, 87(3), 567-576.

Online

Crawford, James. 2006. *The creation of states in international law*: Oxford University Press.

State Transformation and State Failure

States emerge and disappear for various reasons. Some of these transformations are peaceful whereas others are violent. What accounts for regime transition? What is the role of domestic and foreign factors in challenging state sovereignty?

- Skocpol, T. (1979) *States and social revolutions: A comparative analysis of France, Russia and China* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). **HM283.SKO**
 - An authoritative account of how revolutions emerge and what their implications are for state transformation, focusing on the cases of the French, Russian and Chinese revolution.

SOLO

Online

- Fukuyama, F. (2011) *The Origins of Political Order: From Prehuman Times to the French Revolution* (Profile Books).
 - A very ambitious book that tries to trace the origins of state formation and stability from the early man to modernity.

SOLO

Online

- *Herbst, J. (2000) *States and Power in Africa: Comparative Lessons in Authority and Control*. (Princeton NJ: Princeton University Press.)
 - A classic study that sheds light on the variation in state legitimacy and endurance in Africa, recently updated to incorporate new developments in the continent.

SOLO

Online

- Bratton, M. and Van de Walle, N. (1994) 'Neopatrimonial Regimes and Political Transitions in Africa', *World Politics*, 46(4), 453-489.
 - The article compares the patrimonial roots of some African states and compares them to the corporatist tradition of Latin American and Southern Europe to examine the reasons why some democratic transitions in Africa have been successful whereas other were not. The argument has been further developed in the following volume:

Online

- ** Bates, R. (2008) 'State Failure', *Annual Review of Political Science*, 11(1-2).
 - The article examines the role of state revenues, private incomes and ethnic heterogeneity on state failure.

Online

- Caplan, Richard. 2005. *International governance of war-torn territories: rule and reconstruction*. Oxford University Press.

Fixing Fragile States

The following three articles discuss alternative policy responses to state failure in Africa and other parts of the world:

- Herbst, J. (1997) 'Responding to state failure in Africa', *International Security*, 21(3).

Online

- Ghani, A. and Lockhart, C. (2008) *Fixing Failed States: A Framework for Rebuilding a Fractured World*. (Oxford: Oxford University Press) **JC328.7.GHA**

SOLO

- Kaplan, S. (2008) *Fixing Fragile States: A New Paradigm for Development*. (New York: Praeger). **JF60.KAP**

SOLO

- Rotberg, R. ed. (2003) *When States Fail: Causes and Consequences*. (Princeton NJ: Princeton University Press). **JF60.WHE**

- Chapter one in this volume provides a theoretical classification of state failures. The rest of the book is divided in two parts: the first looks at the correlates of state failure and the second surveys methods to prevent it.

SOLO

Online

- Zartman, I.W. ed (1995) *Collapsed States: The Disintegration and Restoration of Legitimate Authority*. Boulder, (CO: Lynne Rienner) **JQ1879.A15.COL**
 - An excellent volume on the roots of state collapse and on the factors aiding its restoration. The introduction sets the theoretical debate clarifying the meaning of state failure and state restoration.

SOLO

Top

COLONIALISM

Introduction

This topic examines the relationship between colonial rule and various outcomes, such as democracy and economic well-being. The scope of the lecture and the readings is to enhance your understanding on the long-term consequences of colonialism. We will examine both the economic and political dimensions of colonial legacy. We will study colonial structures from a comparative perspective, exploring different structures and traditions. We will delve into questions such as why some colonial systems left a stronger imprint than others and we will investigate conditions that determined the variation in the long-term consequences of colonial rule.

Essay Questions

- What effects did colonial occupation have on the trajectory of democracy in colonised countries?
- How did different colonial institutions affect economic and political outcomes in former colonies?

Overviews and historical accounts

- Mamdani, Mahmood. 1996. *Citizen and subject: Contemporary Africa and the Legacy of Late Colonialism*. Princeton University Press
- *Acemoglu, Daron, and James Robinson. 2012. *Why nations fail*. New York: Crown Business. Chapters 1-4, 9-10.
- Lange, Matthew. 2009. *Lineages of despotism and development: British colonialism and state power*. University of Chicago Press.

Colonialism and democratic outcomes

- Kenneth A. Bollen and Robert W. Jackman, 'Economic and noneconomic determinants of political democracy in the 1960s', *Research in Political Sociology* 1 (1985), 27-48

Online

- Myron Weiner, 'Empirical democratic theory', in Myron Weiner and Ergun Ozbudun (eds.), *Competitive elections in developing countries* (Durham, NC, 1987). **JF60.COM**

SOLO

- *Robert D. Woodberry, 'The Missionary Roots of Liberal Democracy', *American Political Science Review*, 106 (2012), 244-274.
- *Michael Bernhard et al., 'The legacy of western overseas colonialism on democratic survival', *International Studies Quarterly* 48 (2004), 225-50.

Online

Colonial institutions and outcomes

- **Daron Acemoglu et al., 'The colonial origins of comparative development: an empirical investigation', *American Economic Review*, 91 (2001), 1369-1401, and *idem*, 'Reversal of fortune: geography and institutions in the making of the modern world income distribution', *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 117 (2002), 1231-1294;

Online

- Edward C. Glaeser et al., 'Do institutions cause growth?'. *Journal of Economic Growth*, 9 (2004), 271-303.

Online

- *Austin, Gareth. 2008. 'The "reversal of fortune" thesis and the compression of history: Perspectives from African and comparative economic history.' *Journal of international development* no. 20 (8):996-1027.
 - Bandyopadhyay, Sanghamitra, and Elliott Green. 2012. 'The reversal of fortune thesis reconsidered.' *Journal of Development Studies* no. 48 (7):817-831.
 - Matthew K. Lange et al., 'Colonialism and development: a comparative analysis of Spanish and British colonies.' *American Journal of Sociology* 111 (2006) 1412-62.
- Online
- Matthew D. Fails and Jonathan Kriekhaus , 'Colonialism, property rights, and the modern world income distribution', *British Journal of Political Science*, 40 (2010), 487-508.
- Online
- *Jack Paine. 2019. 'Democratic Contradictions in European Settler Colonies,' *World Politics*, 71(3): 542-585.

Specific cases of colonial power

- **Herbst, Jeffrey. 2000. *States and Power in Africa*. Chapter 3.
- Young, Crawford. 1994. *The African Colonial State in Comparative Perspective*. New Haven: Yale University Press. Chapter 5 ("The Colonial State Institutionalized").
- **Iyer, Lakshmi, and Abhijit Banerjee. 'History, Institutions, and Economic Performance: The Legacy of Colonial Land Tenure Systems in India.' *American economic review* 95.3 (2005): 1190-1213.
- James Mahoney. 2010. *Colonialism and Postcolonial Development: Spanish America in Comparative Perspective*. Cambridge University Press. Chapters 1,2,6.
- Nunn, Nathan, and Wantchekon. 2011. 'The Slave Trade and the Origins of Mistrust in Africa.' *American Economic Review* no. 101 (7):3221-3252.
- Pepinsky, Thomas B. 2016. 'Colonial migration and the origins of governance: Theory and evidence from Java.' *Comparative Political Studies* no. 49 (9):1201-1237.
- *Alexander Lee and Jack Paine. 2019. 'British Colonialism and Democracy: Divergent Inheritances and Diminishing Legacies,' *Journal of Comparative Economics*, 47(3): 487–503.

Economic legacies of colonialism

- *Nunn, Nathan. 2009. 'The Importance of History for Economic Development', *Annual Review of Economics*, 1(1), 65-92

- *Tomila Lankina and Lullit Getachew, 'Mission or Empire, Word or Sword? The Human Capital Legacy in Postcolonial Democratic Development', *American Journal of Political Science*, 56 (2012), 465-483.

Online

- Michalopoulos, Stelios, and Papaioannou, Elias. 2016. 'The Long-Run Effects of the Scramble for Africa,' *American Economic Review*, 106(7), 1802-1848.
- Müller-Crepon, Carl. 2020. 'Continuity or Change? (In)direct Rule in British and French Colonial Africa.' *International Organization* 74(4), 707-741.
- Rabinowitz, Beth. 2020. 'Ethnicity and Power in Sub-Saharan Africa: Do Colonial Institutions Still Matter?' *Comparative Politics* 52(3).
- Alexander Lee and Jack Paine. 2019. 'What Were the Consequences of Decolonization?' *International Studies Quarterly*, 63(2): 406-416.

Pre-colonial trajectories

- *Jack Paine. 2019. 'Ethnic Violence in Africa: Destructive Legacies of Pre-Colonial States,' *International Organization* 73(3): 645-683.
- Huillery, Elise. 2010. 'The Impact of European Settlement within French West Africa: Did Pre-colonial Prosperous Areas Fall Behind?' *Journal of African Economies*, 20(2), pp. 263-311.
- Englebert, Pierre. 2000. 'Pre-colonial institutions, post-colonial states, and economic development in tropical Africa.' *Political Research Quarterly* no. 53 (1):7-36.
- Michalopoulos, Stelios, and Elias Papaioannou. 2013. 'Pre-Colonial Ethnic Institutions and Contemporary African Development.' *Econometrica* no. 81 (1):113-152.

Further reading

- Hochschild, *King Leopold's Ghost: A Story of Greed, Terror and Heroism in Colonial Africa* (Boston, 2012).
- S. Sarkar, 'Indian Democracy: The Historical Inheritance', in A. Kohli (ed), *The Success of India's Democracy* (Cambridge, 2001).
- N. Gooptu, 'The Political Legacy of Colonialism in South Asia' in Peers and Gooptu (eds), *India and the British Empire* (Oxford, 2013). DOI: <https://oxford.universitypressscholarship.com/view/10.1093/acprof:oso/9780199259885.001.0001/acprof-9780199259885-chapter-14>

DEMOCRATIZATION

Introduction

Democratization in the broadest sense is the process by which polities or aspects of polities become more democratic. More narrowly, political scientists more commonly use the term to refer to the process of transition from an authoritarian to a democratic regime type - as in West Germany, Italy, and Japan after the Second World War, and in much of Latin America and the former Soviet bloc during the 1980s and early 1990s. The most recent literature draws upon both usages of the term, emphasizing that transitions to democracy are never fully completed and that democracy deepens gradually, but also stressing that democratization processes are reversible and that they may stall, creating semi-democratic regime types.

The central question we deal with is: What are the determinants of *transition* to democracy? Where does liberal democracy come from? Some theorists focus on the role of structural factors such as the class system, the level of economic development, or the nature of political culture; others emphasize the strategies of the elite actors engaged directly in the events of transition; still others emphasize the interaction of these, or the primacy of 'meso-level' variables, or the importance of the international dimension. How should we evaluate these contrasting accounts and how do they relate to one another?

Essay Questions

- Do “elite-driven” factors matter most for democratization?
- Can international actors affect democratization in a country?

Readings

Text book level introduction to the topic

- *Grugel, J. & Bishop, M.L. (2013). *Democratization: A Critical Introduction*. Palgrave Macmillan. [Introduction]
- **Roberts Clark, W., Golder, M. and Golder, S. (2013) *Principles of Comparative Politics*. (Washington DC: CQ Press) Chs 6, 7 and 8 **JF51.CLA**

- **Geddes, B., (2009) 'What Causes Democratization?' Boix, C. and Stokes, S.C. eds. *The Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch. 14.


Influential and Problem-Framing Texts

Some particularly influential (and at times, controversial) books within the study of democratization:

- *Huntington, S.P. (1991) *The Third Wave: Democratization in the Late Twentieth Century* (Norman: University of Oklahoma Press). **JC421.HUN**

SOLO

- *Linz, J.J. and Stepan, A. (1996) *Problems of Democratic Transition and Consolidation: Southern Europe, South America, and Post-Communist Europe* (Baltimore: Johns Hopkins UP). **JC421.LIN**

SOLO

- *Whitehead, L. (2002) *Democratization: Theory and Experience* (Oxford: OUP) **JC421.WHI**

SOLO

Online

Socio-economic Explanations and Transitions to Democracy

Explanations that see socio-economic conditions as central to democratization begin with modernization theory. Work in this area commonly employs large-n empirical analysis. More recently scholars have also employed formal modelling. Explanations that see socio-economic conditions as central to democratization reach back to modernization theory (Lipset 1959). More recently work in this area has employed large-n empirical analysis (Przeworski et al. 2000, Boix and Stokes 2003) and theoretically, scholars have moved on to formal modelling:

- *Lipset, S.M. (1959) *Political Man: The Social Bases of Politics* (London: Heinemann) Ch. 2 **JC423.LIP**

- A seminal work that sees democracy as the result of modernisation.

SOLO

- *Przeworski, A. et al. (2000) *Democracy and Development: Political Institutions and well-being in the World, 1950-1990* (Cambridge: CUP) Esp. Ch 2. **JC423.DEM.**

- The first global study of economic development and democratization, which argues that development does not in fact shape the probability that states make a transition to democracy, but only the probability that democracy will survive once established.

SOLO

- *Boix, C. and Stokes, S.C. (July 2003) 'Endogenous Democratization', *World Politics*, 55(4), 517-549.

- Challenge the argument by Przeworski et. al. and suggest that the probability of democratization is conditioned by development.

Online

- Acemoglu D. and Robinson, A. (2006) *Economic Origins of Dictatorship and Democracy* (Cambridge: CUP) **JC423.ACE**

- Provides a formal model to theorize the relationship between economic conditions (including inequality, the structure of the economy, economic crises and globalization and the creation and consolidation of democracy)

SOLO

- Robinson, J.A. (2006) 'Economic Development and Democracy' *Annual Review of Political Science*, 9, 503-527.

- A review article of developments in this field

Online

- **Ansell, B. and Samuels, D. (2014) 'Economic Development and Democracy', *Annual Review of Political Science*, 9, 503-527.
 - A new theory of democratization that shows how the impact of income inequality on democratization depends on the existing level of land equality. A very illuminative account that incorporates and extends previous economic theories of regime change.

Online

- Bryn Rosenfeld. 2020. *The Autocratic Middle Class: How State Dependency Reduces the Demand for Democracy*. Princeton University Press.
- Capoccia, G. and Ziblatt, D. (2010) 'The Historical Turn in Democratization Studies: A New Research Agenda for Europe and Beyond', *Comparative Political Studies August/September*, 43, 931-968.

Online

- *Slater, D. (2009) 'Revolutions, Crackdowns, and Quiescence: Communal Elites and Democratic Mobilization in Southeast Asia', *American Journal of Sociology*, 115(1), 203-254.
 - Critiques the democratization literature's excessive focus on class actors and economic factors by highlighting the importance of emotive appeals to nationalist and religious sentiments and solidarities in sparking, sustaining, and sanctifying high-risk protest against authoritarian governments in a historical analysis of seven Southeast Asian countries.

Online

- Tudor, Maya (2013) 'Explaining democracy's origins: Lessons from South Asia', *Comparative Politics* 45(3), 253-272

Democracy from Above: Elites and Elite Strategies

Other accounts focus on the role of splits in the authoritarian elite, and of elite actions during the transition, as critical in explaining transition outcomes:

- **Przeworski, A. (1991) *Democracy and the Market: Political and Economic Reforms in Eastern Europe and Latin America* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) esp Chs. 1 and 2. **HC244.PRZ**

- A clear and highly influential analysis of the role of élites

SOLO

- O'Donnell, G., Schmitter, P.C. and Whitehead, L. (1986) *Transitions from Authoritarian Rule: Prospects for Democracy: Vol. 4: Tentative Conclusions about Uncertain Democracies* (Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press) **JL966.TRA**

- One of the first and most influential élite-based accounts of democratization.

SOLO

- Mainwaring, S. (1992) 'Transitions to Democracy and Democratic Consolidation: Theoretical and Comparative Issues', in Mainwaring, S., O'Donnell, G. and Valenzuela, J.S. eds. *Issues in Democratic Consolidation* (Notre Dame: University of Notre Dame Press) 294-341. **F2237.ISS**

SOLO

- McFaul, M. (2002) 'The Fourth Wave of Democracy and Dictatorship: Noncooperative Transitions in the Postcommunist World.' *World Politics* 54(2), 212-244

Democracy "from Below:" Cultural Factors and Civil Society

Another prominent set of arguments suggest that democratization requires society to have the right 'culture' – that is, values that are compatible with democracy. However, this claim has been the subject of significant debate – including questions about where these values originate, which cultural factors matter, and how strongly this relationship holds. Some emphasize religion as a source of political values. Recent discussion has examined the levels of democratization between Muslim and non-Muslim countries:

- **Muller, E.N. and Seligson, M.A. (1994) "Civic Culture and Democracy: The Question of Causal Relationships", *American Political Science Review*, 88(3), 635-652
 - A very influential examination of the role of civic culture

Online

- **Fish, S. (2002) 'Islam and Authoritarianism', *World Politics*, 55(1), 4-37

Online

- Donno, D. and Russett, B. (2004) 'Islam, Authoritarianism, and Female Empowerment: What Are the Linkages?' *World Politics*, 56(4), 582-607.

Online

- Lust, E. (2011) 'Missing the Third Wave: Islam, Institutions, and Democracy in the Middle East', *Studies in Comparative International Development*, 46, 163–190.

Online

- Kuran, T. (1991) 'Now out of Never: The Element of Surprise in the East European Revolution of 1989', *World Politics*, 44(1), 7-48.

Another important societal-level perspective suggests that—regardless of the source of democratic values—having a robust civil society helps to transmit and channel these values into popular demands:

- Finkel, S.E. and Smith, A.E. (2011) 'Civic Education, Political Discussion, and the Social Transmission of Democratic Knowledge and Values in a New Democracy: Kenya 2002', *American Journal of Political Science*, 55(2), 417-435.
- Bunce, V. and S. Wolchik (2011) *Defeating Authoritarian Leaders in Post-Communist Countries*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. Chapters 1, 2, 8
- Lussier, D.N. and M.S. Fish (2012) 'Indonesia: The benefits of civic engagement.' *Journal of Democracy* 23(1)

International Factors

Beyond domestic politics, scholars also consider the role of foreign actors and international conditions in facilitating democratic transition. Scholars studying these dynamics in comparative perspective often leverage data across a range of regions and historical time periods:

- *Whitehead, L. (2001) *The International Dimensions of Democratization: Europe and the Americas*, rev ed. (Oxford: Oxford University Press) **JC421.INT**

SOLO

Online

- Levitsky, S. and Way, L.A. (July 2005) 'International Linkage and Democratization', *Journal of Democracy*, 16(3), 20-34.
 - On the relationship between domestic and international factors.

Online

- Weyland, K. (2010) 'The Diffusion of Regime Contention in European Democratization, 1830-1940', *Comparative Political Studies*, 43, 1148-1176.
 - This paper examines European democratization from 1830 to 1940. It analyzes the diffusion of regime conflict, and the cross-national spread of judgments about the feasibility of political change.

Online

- Meyerrose A. (2020), "The Unintended Consequences of Democracy Promotion: International Organizations and Democratic Backsliding." *Comparative Political Studies*.

Online

AUTOCRACIES AND HYBRID REGIMES

Introduction

Democracy has only become the modal regime in the world after 1991. Even today, various autocratic regimes seem unchallenged by the democratization wave; some have argued that we are in a 'reverse wave' of autocratization across the globe. How do political institutions operate in these regimes? Why do some of authoritarian regimes have uncompetitive elections and parliaments? We will try to address these questions, looking at the varieties of authoritarianism.

Even among countries that have shifted towards a more democratic regime, transitions from authoritarianism are incomplete, resulting in so-called hybrid regimes. How do these hybrid regimes operate? What are their defining features and how do they differ from authoritarian regimes on the one hand and democratic regimes on the other? What explains the survival and trajectory of these regimes? Why do some of these regimes regress back to authoritarianism whereas others democratize? The readings discuss both "bottom-up" and "top-down" approaches to these questions. With respect to the former, modernization theory will be re-examined, focusing on the role of economic development and inequality. With respect to the latter, particular attention will be drawn to the role of legitimacy, co-optation and repression.

Essay Questions

- 'Rather than a wave of slower pace of democratization, hybrid regimes represent a new equilibrium.' Discuss.
- Which features of hybrid regimes most hinder further democratization?

Introductory Readings

- Roberts Clark, W., Golder, M. and Golder, S. (2017, or the 2013 version of the same book) *Principles of Comparative Politics*. (Washington DC: CQ Press). Chapter 10: "Varieties of Dictatorship"
- Svoboda, Milan. W. 2012. The politics of authoritarian rule. Cambridge University Press. Chapter 2.

Conceptualizing and Classifying Autocracies and Hybrid Regimes

One important debate explores how to define these non-democratic regimes. What is autocracy? How does it differ from democracy? We introduced some of these core conceptual concerns in Prelims, but the debate goes much further. How should we classify the variety of non-democratic regimes? What are the most salient distinctions among them?

- Collier, D. and Levitsky, S. (1997) 'Democracy with Adjectives: Conceptual Innovation in Comparative Research' *World Politics*, 49.
 - On general concepts and theory.

Online

- Bogaards, M. (2009) 'How to classify hybrid regimes? Defective democracy and electoral authoritarianism', *Democratization*, 16(2), 399-423.
 - An encompassing classification of hybrid regimes that suggests to embed the concepts of defective democracy and electoral authoritarianism in a 'double-root

strategy' that maps the full range of contemporary regimes from both sides of the political spectrum.

Online

- Carothers, T. (2002) 'The End of the Transition Paradigm', *Journal of Democracy*, 13, 5–21.
- **Howard, M. and Roessler, P. (2006) 'Liberalizing electoral outcomes in competitive authoritarian regimes', *American Journal of Political Science*, 50(2), 365-381.

Representation and Institutions under Autocratic Rule

Over the past decade, scholars have begun to examine the formal institutions of autocracy. This literature has been motivated by the observation that, despite their significant differences, many democracies and autocracies possess formal political institutions that look quite similar on paper. Many autocracies include 'nominally democratic institutions'—such as parties, elections, and legislatures. Work in this area engages important questions, such as: To what extent are these 'nominally democratic institutions' truly representative? How and why do they arise? Do they contribute to or undermine regime stability?

These readings develop the central arguments in this field:

- **Boix, C. and Svolik, M. (2013) 'The Foundations of Limited Authoritarian Government: Institutions and Power-sharing in Dictatorships', *Journal of Politics*
 - The study delves into the foundations of semi-authoritarian rule.

Online

- Svolik, M. (2009) 'Power-sharing and Leadership Dynamics in Authoritarian Regimes', *American Journal of Political Science*, 53(2), 477-494.
 - How institutions operate in authoritarian regimes.

Online

- *Gandhi, J. (2008) *Political Institutions under Dictatorship* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Ch 3 **JC495.GAN**
 - The book explains how dictators of different types of autocracies manage to balance the trade-off between thwarting rebellion and soliciting cooperation by those they rule.

SOLO

- **Frantz, E. and Kendall-Taylor, A. (2014) 'A dictator's toolkit Understanding how co-optation affects repression in autocracies', *Journal of Peace Research*.
 - The article shows that co-optation through the use of political parties and a legislature creates incentives that lead dictators to decrease empowerment rights restrictions, while increasing physical integrity rights violations.

Online

- Meng, A. (2020) *Constraining Dictatorship*, (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. [Introduction]

- *Gandhi, J. and Lust-Okar, E. (2009) 'Elections under Authoritarianism', *Annual Review of Political Science*, 12.

How Contemporary Autocrats Rule

- Hassan, M., Mattingly, D., and Nugent, E.R. (2022). Political Control. *Annual Review of Political Science*. no. 25, 155-174.
- Guriev, S., and Treisman, D. Informational Autocrats. *Journal of Economic Perspectives* 33, no. 4 (2019): 100–127.
- Piotrowska, B. (2020). The Price of Collaboration: How Authoritarian States Retain Control. *Comparative Political Studies*, 53(13): 2091-2117.
- Johannes Gerschewski. (2013). The three pillars of stability: legitimization, repression, and co-optation in autocratic regimes, *Democratization*, 20:1, 13-38.
- Blaydes, Lisa. *State of Repression: Iraq under Saddam Hussein*. Princeton University Press, 2018. [Chapter 2]
- King, G., Pan, J., and Roberts, M.E. (2013). How censorship in China allows government criticism but silences collective expression. *American Political Science Review* 107(2): 326-343.
- Magaloni, B. (2008) *Voting for Autocracy: Hegemonic Party Survival and its Demise in Mexico* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Chs 1 and 2 **JL1298.R34.MAG**
 - The chapters explain why Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI) survived so long as a dominant party and shows how elections facilitated the endurance of the regime.

While most of the literature focuses on the actions and preferences of rulers, authoritarian regimes may also require some level of society support. These readings discuss the factors that influence citizens' attitudes and behaviour in these regimes.

- Young, L.E., 2019. The psychology of state repression: Fear and dissent decisions in Zimbabwe. *American Political Science Review*, 113(1), pp.140-155
- Buckley, N., Marquardt, K., Reuter, O., & Tertychnaya, K. Endogenous Popularity: How Perceptions of Support Affect the Popularity of Authoritarian Regimes. *American Political Science Review*. 1-7. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0003055423000618>
- Mattingly, D. (2020) *The Art of Political Control in China* (New York: Cambridge University Press)
- Fu, D. (2016) 'Disguised Collective Action in China' *Comparative Political Studies* 50(4), 499-527

Natural resources, political economy, and authoritarian survival

- **Ross, M. (2015), 'What Have We Learned about the Resource Curse?' *Annual Review of Political Science*, 18:1, pp. 239-25
- Brooks, S. M., & Kurtz, M. J. (2022). Oil "Rents" and Political Development: What Do We Really Know About the Curse of Natural Resources?. *Comparative Political Studies*, 00104140211060281.

POLITICAL PARTIES AND PARTY SYSTEMS

Introduction

Organized political parties are found in all contemporary democracies, and in many countries the growth of parties preceded democratization. Typically parties are involved in the mobilization of mass electorates and in competing for public office, and some parties then are engaged in government itself. Questions about parties involve these main areas of study:

- how parties are *formed*, how they link with particular groups in society and how they reflect social divisions in a given country;
- how parties *organize* themselves for the purposes of competing for power, and the relationship between the party organizations and their members or activists;
- how parties *compete*; the logic of party competition (and co-operation between parties) and the differences in the behaviour of the party systems found in various democratic regimes.

Essay Questions

- Is there an increasing tendency for parties to converge on the political centre-ground?
- How can change in party systems best be explained?

Readings

Text book level introduction to the topic

- **Roberts Clark, W., Golder, M. and Golder, S. (2013) *Principles of Comparative Politics*. (Washington DC: CQ Press) Ch 13. **JF51.CLA**
 - *This is an excellent introduction to the literature on parties and party systems*

SOLO

Parties, Party Systems and Party-Voter Linkages

Much of the literature on party competition focuses on how parties appeal to voters. Classic studies often have their roots in the study of Western Europe and see party-voter linkages as programmatic and the bases for them as social and ideological. Work on party-voter linkages in other parts of the world often stress alternatives to programmatic linkages, in particular clientelism.

Parties and Party Systems

- *Lipset, S.M. and Rokkan, S. (1967) *Party Systems and Voter Alignments: Cross-National Perspectives* (New York: Free Press) Introduction **JF2051.LIP**
 - Develops the argument of frozen cleavages. Part of this chapter is excerpted in Peter Mair ed. *The West European Party System* (Oxford: OUP, 1990) 91-138 **JN94.A979.WES**

SOLO

- **Boix, Carles (2007). "The Emergence of Parties and Party Systems." In *Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics*, eds. Carles Boix and Susan C. Stokes. Oxford, New York: Oxford University Press, 499–521

- **Mair, Peter, and Cas Mudde (1998) “The Party Family and Its Study.” *Annual Review of Political Science* 1 (1): 211–29
- **Sartori, Giovanni (1976) *Parties and Party Systems*. Cambridge (Mass.): Cambridge University Press (reprinted 2005 as ECPR classic with new introduction by the author). (Ch1, 2, 6)
- *Hooghe, Liesbet, and Gary Marks. 2018. “Cleavage theory meets Europe’s crises: Lipset, Rokkan, and the transnational cleavage.” *Journal of European Public Policy* 25 (1): 109–35.
- *Thachil, T. (2014) “Elite Parties and Poor Voters. Theory and Evidence from India.” *American Political Science Review*, 108, 454 – 477.
- *Amorim Neto, O. and Cox, G. (1997) ‘Electoral Institutions, Cleavage Structures, and the Number of Parties’, *American Journal of Political Science*, 41(1), 149-174.

Online
- Lindberg, S.L. (2007) ‘Institutionalization of Party Systems? Stability and Fluidity among Legislative Parties in Africa’s Democracies’, *Government and Opposition*, 42(2), 215–241

Online
- Dalton, Russell J. (2019) *Citizen Politics: Public Opinion and Political Parties in Advanced Industrial Democracies*, 7th ed (Washington, DC: CQ Press) (Ch. 7-10). **JF2011.DAL2019**
- Mair, P., Müller, W.C. and Plasser, F. eds. (2004) *Political Parties and Electoral Change* (London: SAGE) JN94.A979.POL This is an empirical study that contains chapters discussing party changes in the UK, France, Germany, Italy, Austria, Belgium, Denmark, and Ireland, plus comparative introductory and concluding chapters.
- Haughton, Timothy, and Kevin Deegan-Krause. 2020. *The new party challenge: Changing cycles of party birth and death in central Europe and beyond*. Oxford, New York, NY: Oxford University Press.
- Madrid, R. L. (2012) *The Rise of Ethnic Politics in Latin America*. New York: Cambridge UP. F1434.2.P76.MAD 2012 and as E-book on Solo.
- Evans, Geoffrey, ed. (1999) *The End of Class Politics? Class Voting in Comparative Context* (Oxford: Oxford UP) (esp. introduction for different measures of class voting and an overview of the findings)
- Rueda, D. (2005) ‘Insider–Outsider Politics in Industrialized Democracies: The Challenge to Social Democratic Parties’, *American Political Science Review*, 99, 61-74

Voter-party linkages

- **Kitschelt, Herbert. 2000. “Linkages between Citizens and Politicians in Democratic Politics.” *Comparative Political Studies* 33 (6-7): 845–79.
- **Kitschelt, H. and Wilkinson, S. (2007) ‘Citizen-politician Linkages: An Introduction’, in Kitschelt and Wilkinson ed. *Patrons, Clients and Policies: Patterns of Democratic Accountability and Political Competition* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). (See Ch. 1 by Kitschelt and Wilkinson, Ch. 2 by van de Walle on Africa, Ch. 9 by Levitsky on

Latin America, and Ch. 13 by Kitschelt on the demise of clientelism in affluent capitalist democracies). **JF2111.PAT**

- Lupu, Noam. 2016. *Party brands in crisis: Partisanship, brand dilution, and the breakdown of political parties in Latin America*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. Ch 1-3

Party Organizations

Typically parties have fewer members than they used to, but there is a major debate as to whether this means that members are less useful to parties than they were earlier. In this debate, authors have formulated different types of parties (esp. Duverger, Kirchheimer, Katz and Mair). Scarrow, Webb, and Poguntke's recent volume questions the empirical value of the broad party types formulated by Duverger and others by revealing the ongoing variation in party organizations.

- **Scarrow, Susan, Paul D. Webb and Thomas Poguntke (2017) *Organizing Political Parties* (Oxford: Oxford UP) (esp. intro & concl.). **JK2261.ORG 2017**
- Bolleyer, Nicole, and Evelyn Bytcek (2013) "Origins of Party Formation and New Party Success in Advanced Democracies." *European Journal of Political Research* 52(6): 773-796.
- *Kirchheimer, O. (1966) 'The Transformation of the Western European Party Systems', in La Palombara, J. and Weiner, M. *Political Parties and Political Development* (Princeton: Princeton University Press) 177-200. **JF2051.POL.**
 - Sets out the model of the 'catch-all party' and discusses the nature of such a party's links with voters. Part of this chapter is excerpted in Mair, P. ed. (1990) *The West European Party System* (Oxford: OUP), 50-60 **JN94.A979.WES]**

SOLO

- *Tavits, Margit. 2013. *Post-communist democracies and party organization*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- **Katz, R. and Mair, P. (1995) 'Changing Models of Party Organization and Party Democracy: The Emergence of the Cartel Party', *Party Politics* 1(1), 5-28. Key article, arguing that a new party type - the cartel party - has superseded Kirchheimer's catch-all party.
- *Bentancur, Verónica, Rafael Pineiro Roríguez and Fernando Rosenblatt (2020) *How Party Activism Survives. Uruguay's Frente Amplio* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) (esp. Ch. 1, 3, 4, 6, 7). **E-book via SOLO.**
- Hunter, Wendy (2010) *The Transformation of the Workers' Party in Brazil, 1989-2009* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) (Ch. 1-5). **E-book via SOLO**

Party competition

Political parties competing for votes is a central process of liberal democracies. Scholars have developed different ways of conceptualizing this competition and the link between party appeals and voter behaviour. The seminal starting point for much of this literature is Downs' spatial model.

- **Downs, Anthony (1957) *An Economic Theory of Democracy* (New York: Harper and Row) (esp. Ch. 7 and 8). **JF1351.DOW**
- **Green-Pedersen, Christoffer. 2007. "The Growing Importance of Issue Competition: The Changing Nature of Party Competition in Western Europe." *Political Studies* 55 (3): 607-28
- **Strøm, Kaare. 1990. "A Behavioral Theory of Competitive Political Parties." *American Journal of Political Science* 34 (2): 565-98
- **de Vries, Catherine E., and Sara B. Hobolt. 2020. *Political entrepreneurs: The rise of challenger parties in Europe*. Princeton, New Jersey: Princeton University Press. Ch 1, 2

- Abou-Chadi, Tarik. 2016. "Niche Party Success and Mainstream Party Policy Shifts - How Green and Radical Right Parties Differ in Their Impact." *British Journal of Political Science* 46 (2): 417–36
- Meguid, Bonnie M. 2008. *Party Competition between Unequals: Strategies and Electoral Fortunes in Western Europe*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press
- Somer-Topcu, Zeynep. 2015. "Everything to Everyone: The Electoral Consequences of the Broad-Appeal Strategy in Europe." *American Journal of Political Science* 59 (4): 841–54
- Rovny, Jan (2012) 'Who Emphasizes and who blurs? Party strategies in multidimensional competition,' *European Union Politics*, 13(2): 269-92.

Additional readings – classics and background

- Aldrich, J. (1995) *Why Parties? The Origin and Transformation of Party Politics in America*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press. **JK2261.ALD.**

- Duverger, M. (1955) *Political Parties: Their Organization and Activity in the Modern State* (London: Methuen) **JF2051.DUV**

- Panebianco, Angelo. 1988. *Political parties: Organization and power. Cambridge studies in modern political economies*. Cambridge, New York: Cambridge University Press
- Schattschneider, E. E. 1942. *Party Government*. New York: Farrar & Rinehart
- Stokes, D. (1963) 'Spatial Models of Party Competition', *American Political Science Review*, 57(2), 368-77. A classic critique of spatial models by Donald Stokes, who introduces the notion of valence politics.
- *Riker, William (1982) 'The two-party System and Duverger's Law', *American Political Science Review*, 76(4), 753-766.
- Cox, Gary (1997) *Making Votes Count: Strategic Coordination in the World's Electoral Systems* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) (Ch. 1-3, 7, 11). **JF1001.COX**

Additional readings

- Bartolini, Stefano, and Peter Mair. 1990. *Identity, Competition and Electoral Availability: The Stabilisation of European Electorates, 1885-1985*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- *Adams, James and Samuel Merrill III. 2009. "Policy Seeking Parties in a Parliamentary Democracy with Proportional Representation: A Valence Uncertainty Model." *British Journal of Political Science*, 39(3): 539-58.
- Budge, I. (1994) 'A New Spatial Theory of Party Competition: Uncertainty, Ideology and Policy Equilibria Viewed Comparatively and Temporally', *British Journal of Political Science*, 24(4), 443-467.
- Kitschelt, Herbert. 1989. "The Internal Politics of Parties: The Law of Curvilinear Disparity Revisited." *Political Studies* 37: 400–421
- Kitschelt, Herbert. 1994. *The transformation of European social democracy. Cambridge studies in comparative politics*. Cambridge and New York: Cambridge University Press.

- Kitschelt, Herbert. 2007. "Party Systems." In *Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics*, eds. Carles Boix and Susan C. Stokes. Oxford, New York: Oxford University Press, 522–54
- Laver, Michael. 2005. "Policy and the Dynamics of Political Competition." *American Political Science Review* 99 (2): 263–81
- Mair, Peter. 1997. *Party System Change: Approaches and Interpretations*. Oxford, New York: Oxford University Press.
- Mueller, W. and Strom, K. (1999) *Policy, Office or Votes: How Political Parties in Western Europe Make Hard Decisions* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) JN94.A979.POL
- Wagner, Markus, and Thomas M. Meyer. 2014. "Which Issues do Parties Emphasise? Salience Strategies and Party Organisation in Multiparty Systems." *West European Politics* 37 (5): 1019–45.



Top

ELECTORAL SYSTEMS

Introduction

Electoral systems are key for the distribution of power in a democratic system. Given their considerable effects on the relative power of different political actors and on representation in general, the processes through which they are chosen or manipulated is highly political. Questions regarding electoral systems fall in the following broad areas:

- How should electoral systems be *classified*?

Electoral systems are highly complex and technical pieces of legislation. However, only some electoral rules (such as the formula, or the district structure, or the existence of legal thresholds, etc.) matter, and form the basis of formal classifications and typologies.

- What are the political *consequences* of electoral systems?

What, for example, are the consequences of a certain electoral system on how electors cast their vote, or on the translation of votes into seats, or more generally on the functioning of a political system?

- What are the *origins* of electoral systems?

Electoral systems are determinants of political outcomes, but they are a political outcome themselves: what causes the choice of a certain electoral system, or its reform?

In recent years, many countries, both old and new democracies, have adopted electoral systems that combine different elements of older types, thereby increasing the number and the variety of the existing systems, and posing a challenge to the analysts of the political consequences of electoral systems.

Essay questions

- Has the classification of electoral systems in 'majority' and 'proportional' been made obsolete by the recent emergence and diffusion of 'mixed' electoral systems?

Reading suggestions: start with some of the core readings to reconstruct the rationale and nature of the dichotomy majoritarian-proportional electoral systems; then look at the concept of 'mixed' electoral system, considering whether these systems constitute a class of their own or can be reabsorbed in the two classes of the traditional classification.

- What impact does the electoral system have on the shape and operation of the party system?

Reading suggestions: Begin by isolating the different effects of electoral systems on the electors and on the distribution of seats. Then differentiate how these effects play out on the 'shape' (the numerical format), on the one hand, and the 'operation' (the competitive and coalitional dynamics) of the party system, on the other.

- What are the determinants of electoral reform?

Reading suggestions: distinguish between the initial choice of an electoral system in a new democracy, which has to do mainly with the nature of the regime transition, and the reform of an existing electoral system in an already existing democracy, on which the literature below mainly concentrates.

Readings

Text book level introduction to the topic

- **Roberts Clark, W., Golder, M. and Golder, S. (2013) *Principles of Comparative Politics*. (Washington DC: CQ Press) Ch 12 **JF51.CLA**

SOLO

- **Bowler, S. (2008) 'Electoral Systems', in *The Oxford Handbook of Political Institutions* (Oxford: Oxford University Press), Ch 29.

Online

Electoral System Classification

Proportional vs majoritarian distinction:

- **Lijphart, A. (1999) *Patterns of Democracy: Government Forms and Performance in Thirty-Six Countries* (New Haven: Yale University Press) Chapter 8. **JC421.LIJ**
 - This is a very important work that categorises electoral systems as essentially either majority or proportional.

SOLO

- *Bingham-Powell, G. (2000) *Elections as Instruments of Democracy: Majoritarian and Proportional Visions* (New Haven: Yale University Press) **JF1001.POW**

SOLO

- Sartori, G. (2002) *Comparative Constitutional Engineering: An Inquiry into Structures, Incentives and Outcomes*, 2nd ed (Basingstoke: Macmillan) Pt 1 **JF51.SAR**

SOLO

Classifications on the intra-party dimension:

- Carey, J. M., & Shugart, M. S. (1995). Incentives to cultivate a personal vote: A rank ordering of electoral formulas. *Electoral Studies*, 14(4), 417-439.

Online

- Grofman, B. (2005). Comparisons among electoral systems: distinguishing between localism and candidate-centered politics. *Electoral Studies*, 24(4), 735-740.

Mixed-Member Electoral Systems:

- **Shugart, M.S. and Wattenberg, M.P. eds. (2001) *Mixed-Member Electoral Systems: The Best of Both Worlds?* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) **JF1071.MIX**

SOLO

- Federico, F. and Herron, E.S. (2005) 'Going it alone? Strategic Entry Under Mixed Electoral Rules', *American Journal of Political Science*, 49(1), 16-31.
 - Argues that mixed electoral systems present unique 'contamination' effects.
- Moser, R.G. and Scheiner, E. (2004) 'Mixed Electoral System Effects: Controlled Comparison and Cross-National Analysis', *Electoral Studies*, 23(4), 575-599.
 - Argues that, against the expectations of 'contamination' effects, in institutionalised party systems the PR and single-member district plurality components of mixed-member systems behave similarly to the 'pure' forms of two electoral system types.
- Riera, P. (2013) 'Electoral coordination in mixed-member systems: Does the level of democratic experience matter?' *European Journal of Political Research*, 52(1), 119-141.
 - MM systems face problems of coordination in the nominal tier, which are mediated by the experience of uninterrupted democratic rule.

Origins of Electoral Systems and Electoral Reform

On the issue of the endogeneity of electoral systems:

- **Colomer, J. M. (2005). It's parties that choose electoral systems (or, Duverger's laws upside down). *Political Studies*, 53(1), 1-21.
 - Argues that party systems serve to crystallise the configurations of parties that existed at their onset, rather than shaping party systems, as assumed by the Duvergerian literature.
- Andrews, J. T., & Jackman, R. W. (2005). Strategic fools: electoral rule choice under extreme uncertainty. *Electoral Studies*, 24(1), 65-84.
 - Casts doubt on the extent to which parties can really engineer electoral systems to secure their electoral position.
- Rodden, J. (2009) 'Back to the Future: Endogenous Institutions and Comparative Politics' in Lichbach, M.I. and Zuckerman, A. eds. *Comparative Politics: Rationality, Culture and Structure 2nd ed.* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JA86.COM**
 - An excellent synthesis of the literature on the origins of electoral systems with sustained attention to endogeneity as a basic challenge to attempts to theorize and examine the effects of institutions.



On the debate over the origins of PR in Europe:

- **Boix, C. (1999) 'Setting the Rules of the Game: The Choice of Electoral Systems in Advanced Democracies', *American Political Science Review*, 93(3), 609-624.
 - This work sparked an important debate in APSR 2010 on the use of historical and quantitative evidence in comparative political science.



- **Cusack, T., Iversen, T. and Soskice, D. (2010) 'Coevolution of Capitalism and Political Representation: The Choice of Electoral Systems', *American Political Science Review*, 104(2), 393-403.

[Online](#)

- *Ahmed, A. (2010). Reading history forward: The origins of electoral systems in European democracies. *Comparative Political Studies*, 43(8-9), 1059-1088.
- *Kreuzer, M. (2010) 'Historical Knowledge and Quantitative Analysis: The Case of the Origins of Proportional Representation', *American Political Science Review*, 104(2), 369-392.
- Blais, A., Dobrzynska, A., and Indridason, I. H. (2005). To adopt or not to adopt proportional representation: The politics of institutional choice. *British Journal of Political Science*, 35(1), 182-190.
- Schröder, V., and Manow, P. (2020). An intra-party account of electoral system choice. *Political Science Research and Methods*, 8(2), 251-267.

On electoral system reform:

- *Benoit, K. (2004) 'Models of Electoral System Change' *Electoral Studies*, 23(3), 363-389.

[Online](#)

- Bol, D., Pilet, J-B. and Riera, P. (2013) 'The international diffusion of electoral systems: The spread of mechanisms tempering proportional representation across Europe.' *European Journal of Political Research*, 54(2), 384-410.
 - Shows how specific mechanisms that constrain the effects of PR on party system fragmentation have spread around Europe since 1945.

[Online](#)

- Katz, R.S. (2005) 'Why Are There So Many (Or So Few) Electoral Reforms?' in Gallagher, M. and Mitchell, P. eds. *The Politics of Electoral Systems* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) 57-76 **JF1001.POL**
 - The edited collection includes many valuable single-country case studies on reform (or non-reform) of electoral institutions.

[SOLO](#)

[Online](#)

- Renwick, A. (2010) *The Politics of Electoral Reform: Changing the Rules of Democracy* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). Especially Chapters 1-4 and 13. **JF1001.REN**

[SOLO](#)

Normative considerations on electoral system choice (which system is 'best?')

- Lijphart, A. and Grofman, B. eds. (1984) *Choosing an Electoral System: Issues and Alternatives* (New York: Praeger). **JF1051.CHO**
 - Presents arguments for and against different electoral systems.

[SOLO](#)

- Shugart, M.S. and Wattenberg, M.P. eds. (2001) 'Conclusion: Are Mixed-Member Systems the Best of Both Worlds?', in *Mixed-Member Electoral Systems: The Best of Both Worlds?* (Oxford: OUP) 571-596, esp. 571-581. **JF1071.MIX**



- Carey, J. M., & Hix, S. (2011). The electoral sweet spot: Low-magnitude proportional electoral systems. *American Journal of Political Science*, 55(2), 383-397.
- Pinto-Duschinsky, M. (1999). Send the rascals packing: defects of proportional representation and the virtues of the Westminster Model. *Representation*, 36: pp. 117–126

Consequences of Electoral System Choice

- *Norris, P. (2004) *Electoral Engineering: Voting Rules and Political Behavior* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JF1001.NOR**
 - Broad overviews of the consequences of electoral institutions, looking at the ‘effects’ of electoral systems not just upon the number of parties, but also, for example, upon turnout and the representation of women and ethnic minorities.



Consequences for party systems:

- **Shugart, M. S., & Taagepera, R. (2017). Votes from seats: Logical models of electoral systems. Cambridge University Press. Chapters 1-9.
 - An extended, updated account of the seat-product model, a valuable predictive tool to quantify the effect of electoral systems on inter-party characteristics of a party system. Focus particularly on Chapter 7.
- **Cox, G.W. (1997) *Making Votes Count: Strategic Coordination in the World's Electoral Systems* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Chs. 1-3 and Conclusion **JF1001.COX**
 - Seminal the study on electoral system effects.
- **Amorim Neto, O. and Cox, G.W. (1997) ‘Electoral Institutions, Cleavage Structures, and the Number of Parties’, *American Journal of Political Science*, 41(1), 149-174.
 - Cross-national analysis of the interaction between electoral systems and cleavage structures in shaping the party system.



- Mozaffar, S., Scarritt, J. R., & Galaich, G. (2003). Electoral institutions, ethnopolitical cleavages, and party systems in Africa's emerging democracies. *American Political Science Review*, 97(3), 379-390.
- Kostadinova, T. (2002). Do mixed electoral systems matter? A cross-national analysis of their effects in Eastern Europe. *Electoral Studies*, 21(1), 23-34.
- Dow, J. K. (2011). Party-system extremism in majoritarian and proportional electoral systems. *British Journal of Political Science*, 41(2), 341-361.

Consequences for participation:

- *Brockington, D., 2004. The paradox of proportional representation: The effect of party systems and coalitions on individuals' electoral participation. *Political Studies*, 52(3), pp.469-490.

- Cox, G. W., Fiva, J. H., & Smith, D. M. (2016). The contraction effect: How proportional representation affects mobilization and turnout. *The Journal of Politics*, 78(4), 1249-1263.
- Skorge, Ø. S. (2021). Mobilizing the Underrepresented: Electoral Systems and Gender Inequality in Political Participation. *American Journal of Political Science*.

Consequences for accountability:

- *Kam, C., Bertelli, A. M., & Held, A. (2020). The electoral system, the party system and accountability in parliamentary government. *American Political Science Review*, 114(3), 744-760.
- Chang, E.C.C. and Golden, M.A. (2007) 'Electoral systems, district magnitude and corruption' *British Journal of Political Science*, 37, 115-137.

- Kunicova, J., & Rose-Ackerman, S. (2005). Electoral rules and constitutional structures as constraints on corruption. *British Journal of Political Science*, 35(4), 573-606.

Consequences for representation:

- *McAllister, I., & Studlar, D. T. (2002). Electoral systems and women's representation: a long-term perspective. *Representation*, 39(1), 3-14.
- Bawn, K. and Thies, M.F. (2003) 'A comparative theory of electoral incentives - Representing the unorganized under PR, plurality and mixed-member electoral systems,' *Journal of Theoretical Politics*, 15(1), 5-32.

- Valdin, M. E. (2012). A deterrent to diversity: The conditional effect of electoral rules on the nomination of women candidates. *Electoral Studies*, 31(4), 740-749.
- Bernauer, J., Giger, N., & Rosset, J. (2015). Mind the gap: Do proportional electoral systems foster a more equal representation of women and men, poor and rich?. *International Political Science Review*, 36(1), 78-98.

Consequences for economic policy and outcomes:

- *Iversen, T., & Soskice, D. (2006). Electoral institutions and the politics of coalitions: Why some democracies redistribute more than others. *American Political Science Review*, 100(2), 165-181.
 - A seminal account of the proportionality-redistribution nexus. Feel free to skim past the formal model and focus on the argument.
- Knutsen, C. H. (2011). Which democracies prosper? Electoral rules, form of government and economic growth. *Electoral Studies*, 30(1), 83-90.
- Persson, Torsten, & Tabellini, G. (2006) "Electoral systems and economic policy." In Weingast and Wittman (eds.) *Oxford Handbook of Political Economy* (2006), Ch. 40.



EXECUTIVES

Introduction

The executive is the core of the state. It initiates policy and oversees its implementation. The executive in democracies typically comprises a small elected component and a very large unelected one typically recruited by merit into civilian and military services. This topic deals with the former, which we may refer to as the “political executive” (the latter is typically known under the heading of “bureaucracy”). The relationship between these two components is usually marked by substantial cooperation qualified by differences of interest, culture, and motivation.

The political executive provides (or at least attempts to provide) leadership to other parts of the state - notably to the bureaucracy, to the legislature, to regional and local governments. It also provides leadership, often through political parties, to voters and societal groups. As such, the executive's relations with other institutions are central to many of the questions we ask. Those questions fall into three broad areas:

- What different *institutional forms* do executives take? The distinction between parliamentarism and presidentialism will already be familiar to you. These constitute different ways of organizing the executive and relations between the executive and the legislature. Many authors also use the category of semi-presidentialism. But others question whether these distinctions have real analytic value.
- What are the *effects* of executive format? Does it matter whether a system is parliamentary or presidential? Do the finer institutional variations among executives make a difference? We may ask about the effects of executive format upon many variables. Within this topic, we focus on effects upon the ability of the system to produce policy and the nature of the policy output. In the topic on democratization, we look at the implications of executive format for democratic survival and development.
- How do *non-institutional factors* affect the nature and behaviour of the executive? It is often argued that the internal operation of an executive and its relations with other branches of government at any time are strongly influenced by non-institutional factors such as leadership quality, the government's popularity, the government's party support base, and events. What impact do such factors have upon the nature of the executive, its relations with the executive, and its policy output? How do institutional and non-institutional factors interact in producing outcomes?

Essay Questions

- How and why does the relationship between an executive's formal authority and its actual power vary within and between states?
- Assess the importance of the trend towards strengthened executive leadership in modern democracies.

Readings

Text book level introduction to the topic

- **Roberts Clark, W., Golder, M. and Golder, S. (2013) *Principles of Comparative Politics*. (Washington DC: CQ Press) **JF51.CLA**

SOLO

- *Shugart, M.S. (2008) 'Comparative Executive–Legislative Relations' in *The Oxford Handbook of Political Institutions* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch 18.

Online

For two conceptual frameworks to understand the meaning and importance of these distinctions see:

- **Strom, K., Muller, W. and Bergman, T. (2003) *Delegation and Accountability in Parliamentary Democracies* (Oxford: Oxford University Press). **JN94.A71.DEL**

SOLO

Online

- **Tsebelis, G. (2002) *Veto Players: How Political Institutions Work*, (Princeton: Princeton University Press) Introduction and Ch. 3. **JF51.TSE**

SOLO

For classic discussions of each of the categories: *Presidentialism, Parliamentarism, and Semi-presidentialism* see:

- Lijphart, A. (1999) *Patterns of Democracy: Government Forms and Performance in Thirty-Six Countries* (New Haven: Yale University Press) Ch. 7 **JC421.LIJ**
 - A quick introduction.

SOLO

- Elgie, R. (1999) *Semi-Presidentialism in Europe* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch 1 **JN12.SEM**

SOLO

Online

- Shugart, M.S. and Carey, J.M. (1992) *Presidents and Assemblies: Constitutional Design and Electoral Dynamics* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). **JF255.SHU**

SOLO

Critiques of the meaning of these categories:

- *Poguntke, T. and Webb, P. (2005) *The Presidentialization of Politics. A Comparative Study of Modern Democracies* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) **JF251.PRE**
 - This work focuses on political practice rather than constitutional rules, and argues that democracies, regardless of their formal constitution, have been undergoing a process of 'presidentialization'.

SOLO

Online

- Siaroff, A. (2003) 'Comparative Presidencies: The Inadequacy of the Presidential, Semi-Presidential and Parliamentary Distinction', *European Journal of Political Research*, 42(3), 287-312.

Online

Effects of Executive Format

For readings concerning effects on democratic survival (note there is some overlap here with the democratization topic):

- **Linz, J. (1990) 'The Perils of Presidentialism', *Journal of Democracy*, 1(1), 51-69.

- **Cheibub, J.A. (2007) *Presidentialism, Parliamentarism and Democracy* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JF255.CHE**

- Lijphart, A. ed. (1992) *Parliamentary versus Presidential Government* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) 1-27 **JF11.PAR**

- **Neto, O. A. (2006). The presidential calculus: Executive policy making and cabinet formation in the Americas. *Comparative Political Studies*, 39(4), 415-440. Available [online](#)
- Sing, M. (2010) 'Explaining Democratic Survival Globally (1946–2002)', *The Journal of Politics*, 72(2), 438-455.


Effects of executive structure on the nature of governments and the policy process:

- **Eaton, K. (2000) 'Parliamentarism versus Presidentialism in the Policy Arena', *Comparative Politics*, 32(3), 355-376
 - A review of several key books on the effects of executive format on policy making.
- *Samuels, D. (2004) 'Presidentialism and Accountability for the Economy in Comparative Perspective', *American Political Science Review*, 98(3), 425-436.

- *Schleiter, P. and Morgan-Jones, E. (2009) 'Review Article: Citizens, Presidents and Assemblies: The Study of Semi-Presidentialism beyond Duverger and Linz' *British Journal of Political Science*, 39(4), 871-892.

- Cheibub, J.A., Przeworski, A. and Saiegh, S.M. (2004) 'Government Coalitions and Legislative Success Under Presidentialism and Parliamentarism', *British Journal of Political Science*, 34(4), 565-587.

- Haggard, S. and McCubbins, M. (2001) *Presidents, Parliaments and Policy* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) esp. Chs 1-2 **JF255.PRE**
 - Offers important arguments regarding both the ability of political systems to produce policy outputs and the nature of those outputs.
- Mainwaring, S. and Shugart, M.S. (1997) *Presidentialism and Democracy in Latin America* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Chs. 1 and 11 **JL961.PRE**
 - Argues that presidential systems vary widely, with implications for policy making.

- Rakner, L. and Van der Walle, N. (2009) 'Opposition Weakness in Africa', *Journal of Democracy*, 20(3), 108-121

Online

- Weaver, K.R. and Rockman, B.A. eds. (1993) *Do Institutions Matter?: Government Capabilities in the United States and Abroad* (Washington, D.C.: Brookings Institution) **JK305.DO**
 - A study of the effects of institutional design upon the capacity of political systems to make and implement policy effectively.

SOLO

Political Executives and Leadership

Overviews of the effects of both institutional and non-institutional factors that shape leadership:

- Arriola, L.R. (2009) 'Patronage and Political Stability in Africa', *Comparative Political Studies*, 42(10), 1339-1362

Online

- Bowles, N. (2003) 'Comparing the Core Executive in Britain, France, and the United States', in Nelson, M. ed. *The Presidency and the Political System*, 7th ed. (Washington DC: CQ Press) 29-47 **JK516.PRE**
 - Outlines four governmental types and discusses factors determining which functions at any given time. Note that this article appears *only* in the 7th edition.

SOLO

- Cranenburgh, O.v. (2008) 'Big Men' Rule: Presidential Power, Regime Type and Democracy in 30 African Countries', *Democratization*, 15(5), 952-973.

Online

- Helms, L. (2005) *Presidents, Prime Ministers and Chancellors: Executive Leadership in Western Democracies* (Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan). **JF251.HEL**
 - Case studies of the chief executives in the US, the UK, and Germany.

SOLO

- Glad B. (1996) 'Passing the Baton: Transformational Political Leadership from Gorbachev to Yeltsin; From de Klerk to Mandela', *Political Psychology*, 17(1), 1-28.
 - Study of the effects of different leader personalities at moments of major political change.

Online

- Skowronek, S. (2006) 'Presidential Leadership in Political Time', in Nelson, M. ed. *The Presidency and the Political System*, 8th edition (Washington, D.C.: CQ Press) 89-135. **JK516.PRE**
 - Argues that the contextual constraints upon US presidents cycle over time. Note that this article has appeared (with alterations) in every edition of Nelson's book.

SOLO

Top

LEGISLATURES

Introduction

Legislatures may play a fundamental role in ensuring popular, representative and accountable government. Yet they vary in composition, structure (bicameralism or unicameralism) and size, and have different relationships with executives and bureaucracies. They also display diverse ways of organizing their business internally through political parties, committees and speakers, which shape their decision-making. Does this institutional diversity impact on the character and quality of democracy? What sort of criteria should we use to evaluate the work and decisions of legislatures? Central questions within this topic fill into three categories:

- What shapes the *role* that legislatures play in democratic governance?
- How does the *structure and composition* of legislatures affect the character and quality of democratic governance?
- How can we *evaluate* the process and results of legislative decision-making?

Two approaches to the study of legislatures dominate the literature. One is inductive, seeking to develop knowledge from careful study of individual cases. The other is deductive, drawing upon social choice theory and formal institutional modelling. It is important to consider how these approaches relate to each other, and how they could learn from each other.

Essay Questions

- What explains variation in the institutional design of modern legislatures?
- Describe the differences in the legislature's role in presidential and parliamentary systems and analyse the consequences for government policy.

Readings

Text book level introductions to the topic:

Parliaments, which originate the executive, differ in important ways from other legislatures that do not. Understanding the functions of assemblies and their relationship to the executive is important in evaluating these institutions. These readings provide a conceptual framework to understand the different functions that assemblies can have in democracies.

- **Laver, M. (2006) 'Legislatures and Parliaments in Comparative Context', in Weingast, B. and Wittman, D. eds. *Oxford Handbook of Political Economy*, (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch 7

Online

- *Carey, J.M. (2008) 'Legislative Organizations' in *The Oxford Handbook of Political Institutions* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch 22

Online

Two approaches that provide a conceptual framework for understanding the impact of legislatures on representation, accountability and the policy process:

- *Strom, K., Muller, W. and Bergman, T. (2003) *Delegation and Accountability in Parliamentary Democracies* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) **JN94.A71.DEL**
 - Particularly chapter 3 on the main differences in the relationship of the legislature to the executive.

SOLO

Online

- Tsebelis, G. (2002) *Veto Players: How Political Institutions Work* (Princeton: Princeton University Press) Chs. 4 and 7 **JF51.TSE**
 - Theoretical approach to legislative-executive relations that reconceptualizes legislative power by reference to agenda setting capacities of governments, and the number of veto players in the assembly.

SOLO

Further Introductory Readings

- Loewenberg, G., Squire, P. and Kiewiet, D.R. (2002) *Legislatures: Comparative Perspectives on Representative Assemblies* (Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Press) **JF511.LEG**

SOLO

- Olson, D. (1994) *Democratic Legislative Institutions: A Comparative View*, (Armonk, NY: M.E.Sharpe) esp Chs. 3-5 **JF501.OLS**
 - A basic overview of key institutional features of legislatures.

SOLO

Online

- Usulaner, E. M, and Zittel, T. 2011. "Comparative Legislative Behavior." In Rhodes, R., Binder, S., and Rockman, B.(eds.), *The Oxford Handbook of Political Institutions*, Oxford: Oxford University Press. Available [Online](#)

On legislative institutionalization

- **Carroll, R., Cox, G.W. and Pachon, M. (2006) 'How Parties Create Electoral Democracy, Part 2', *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, 31(2), 153-174.

Online

- *Andrews, J. T. 2017. Institutionalising Parliaments in Central and Eastern Europe. In Fagan, A., & Kopecký, P. (Eds.). *The Routledge Handbook of East European Politics*. Routledge, pp. 82-99.

SOLO

- Congleton, R.D. (2011) *Perfecting Parliament: Constitutional Reform, Liberalism, and the Rise of Western Democracy* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JC423.CON**

SOLO

- **Cox, G.W. (2006) 'The Organization of Democratic Legislatures' in Weingast, B.R. and Wittman, D.A. *The Oxford Handbook of Political Economy*. (Oxford: Oxford University Press)

Online

- Cox, G.W. and McCubbins, M.D. (2011) 'Managing Plenary Time: The US Congress in Comparative Context', in Lee, F.E. and Schickler, E. eds *The Oxford Handbook of the American Congress*. (Oxford: Oxford University Press)

Online

- Gallagher, M., Laver, M. and Mair, P. (2011) *Representative Government in Modern Europe: Institutions, Parties, and Governments*. (Boston: McGraw Hill). Chapter 3. **JN94.A91.GAL**

SOLO

- *Krehbiel, K. (1991) *Information and Legislative Organization*. (Ann Arbor: Michigan University Press). Chapters 1,7. **JK1061KRE**

SOLO

Online

- *Laver, M. (2006) 'Legislatures and Parliaments', in Weingast, B.R. and Wittman, D.A. eds *The Oxford Handbook of Political Economy* (Oxford: Oxford University Press)

Online

- Rasch, B. (2014). 'Institutional foundations of legislative agenda-setting', in Martin, S., Saalfeld, T. & Strøm, K. (eds.), *The Oxford Handbook of Legislative Studies*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, pp. 456-473. [Online](#)

- Zubek, R. (2011) 'Negative Agenda Control and Executive-Legislative Relations in Central Europe', *Journal of Legislative Studies*, 17(2).

Online

On legislative voting

- **Bowler, S., Farrell, D.M. and Katz, R.S. (1999) *Party Discipline and Parliamentary Government*. (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). Chapters 1-2. **JN94.A979.PAR**

SOLO

- **Carey, J.M. (2007) 'Competing Principals, Political Institutions, and Party Unity in Legislative Voting', *American Journal of Political Science*, 51(1), 92-107.

Online

- **Carey, J.M. (2009) *Legislative Voting and Accountability* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). Chapters 1,5,6. **JF511.CAR**

SOLO

- *Andeweg, R.B. and Thomassen, J. (2011). Pathways to party unity: Sanctions, loyalty, homogeneity and division of labour in the Dutch parliament. *Party Politics*, 17(5), pp.655-672. [Online](#)

- Cox, G.W. and McCubbins, M.D. (2007) *The Legislative Leviathan*. (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). Chapter 6. **JK1429.COX**

SOLO

Online

- *Cox, G.W. and M.D. McCubbins (2011) 'Managing Plenary Time: The US Congress in Comparative Context', in Lee, F.E. and Schickler, E. eds *The Oxford Handbook of the American Congress* (Oxford: Oxford University Press)

Online

- Cox, G.W., Heller, W.B. and McCubbins, M.D. (2008) 'Agenda Power in the Italian Chamber of Deputies, 1988-2000'. *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, 33(2), 171-198.

Online

- Diermeier, D. and Feddersen, T. (1998) 'Cohesion in legislatures and the vote of confidence procedure', *American Political Science Review*, 92, 611-621.

Online

- **Kam, C. (2009) *Party Discipline and Parliamentary Politics* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). Chapters 1,2,10. **JF2051.KAM**

SOLO

- **Sieberer, U. (2006) 'Party Unity in Parliamentary Democracies: A Comparative Analysis' *Journal of Legislative Studies*, 12(2), 150-178.

Online

- **Tavits, M. (2009) 'The Making of Mavericks: Local Loyalties and Party Defection. Comparative Political Studies', *Comparative Political Studies*, 42(6), 793-815.

Online

Categorizing Legislatures and assessing their power and effectiveness

Much of the literature focuses on the role of legislatures in passing legislation and overseeing the executive, others argue that legislatures have many other functions. You may want to consider how far this body of work takes the changing functions of assemblies since the end of the 19th century and their different roles in parliamentary and presidential systems into account.

- *Arter, D., (2007) *Comparing and classifying legislatures* (London: Routledge) **JF511.COM**
 - Also published as special issues of the *Journal of Legislative Studies* 2006, 12(3-4).

SOLO

- *Polsby, N. (1990) 'Legislatures', in Norton, P. ed. *Legislatures* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) 129-148 **JF511.LEG**
 - Introduces the classic differentiation between 'arena' and 'transformative' assemblies.

SOLO

- Primo, D.M. (2007) *Rules and Restraint: Government Spending and the Design of Institutions* (Chicago: Chicago University Press) **HJ257.3.PRI**
 - An important new study showing the effect of legislative design upon the formation of fiscal policy.

SOLO

A much more recent literature considers the interaction of assemblies and presidents:

- **Cox, G. and Morgenstern, S. (2001) 'Latin America's Reactive Assemblies and Proactive Presidents', *Comparative Politics*, 33(2), 171-189.
 - This article is reprinted as the concluding chapter of the following volume:

Online

- Cameron, C.M. (2000) *Veto Bargaining* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). **JK586.CAM**
 - On presidential interaction with the assembly and the impact that presidential vetoes have on legislative decision-making.

SOLO

- Morgenstern, S. and Nacif, B. (2002) *Legislative Politics in Latin America* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JL963.LEG 2002**
 - Especially chapters 6, 8 and 11 by Jones, Carey and Samuels.

SOLO

The Structure and Composition of Legislatures:

- **Shepsle, K.A. and Bonchek, M.S. (1997) *Analyzing Politics: Rationality, Behavior, and Institutions* (New York: W.W.Norton) Chs. 12, 14 and Ch. 5 from p.115. **JA71.SHE**
 - A good introduction to rational choice theory as applied to legislative decision-making and its consequences for understanding the role of parties, committees, and procedures.

SOLO

- Cox, G., (2006) 'The Organization of Democratic Legislatures', in *Oxford Handbook of Political Economy* (Oxford: Oxford University Press)
 - For wide-ranging and very detailed empirical information.

Online

- Yordanova, N. (2009) 'The Rationale behind Committee Assignment in the European Parliament. Distributive, Informational and Partisan Perspectives'. *European Union Politics*, 10(2), 253-280.

On the role of parliamentary and congressional parties see:

- Cox, G. (1987) *The Efficient Secret: The Cabinet and the Development of Political Parties in Victorian England* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JN1120.COX**
 - An exemplary case study of how and why parliamentary organisation changed over time in the UK

SOLO

- *Cox, G., and McCubbins, M. (2007) *Legislative Leviathan: Party Government in the House 2nd ed.* (Berkeley: University of California Press). Chapters 4-5. **JK1429.COX**
 - Argues that parties are crucial to structuring the legislative process in the US Congress.

SOLO

- Bowler, S. (2002) 'Parties in Legislatures: Two Competing Explanations', in Dalton, R.J. and Wattenberg, M.P. eds. *Parties without Partisans: Political Change in Advanced Industrial Democracies* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) 157-179. **JF2051.PAR**
 - Compares two conceptions of the role of parties in legislatures, with important implications for the likely effect on legislatures of change in the nature of parties.

SOLO

Online

- Müller, W. (2000) 'Political Parties in Parliamentary Democracies: Making Delegation and Accountability Work', *European Journal of Political Research*, 37(3), 309-333.
 - Uses a principal-agent approach to argue that strong parties are crucial to a legislature's healthy operation.

Online

On the effects of the design of legislative institutions:

- *Döring, H. (2001) 'Parliamentary Agenda Control and Legislative Outcomes in West Europe', *Legislative Studies Quarterly* 26(1), 145-165.
 - A comprehensive analysis of the impact of agenda-setting rules on legislative outcomes in Western Europe

Online

- Huber, J.D. (1992) 'Restrictive Legislative Procedures in France and the United States', *American Political Science Review*, 86, 675-687.

Online

- Saalfeld, T. (2000) 'Members of Parliament and Governments in Western Europe: Agency relations and Problems of Oversight', *European Journal of Political Research*, 37(3), 353-376.
 - A wide-ranging analysis of the means by which legislatures can hold executives to account, drawing on both research traditions.

Online

- Franchino, F. and Hoyland, B. (2009) 'Legislative Involvement in Parliamentary Systems: Opportunities, Conflict, and Institutional Constraints', *American Political Science Review*, 103(4), 607-621.

Online

On second chambers, see:

- **Roberts Clark, W., Golder, M. and Golder, S. (2013) *Principles of Comparative Politics*. (Washington DC: CQ Press) Ch 14 **JF51.CLA**

SOLO

- Heller, W.B. (2007) 'Divided Politics: Bicameralism, Parties, and Policy in Democratic Legislatures', *Annual Review of Political Science*, 10, 245-269
 - An excellent review of the literature.

Online

- Cutrone, M. and McCarty, N. (2006) 'Does Bicameralism Matter?', in *Oxford Handbook of Political Economy* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch 10.

Online

Top

FEDERALISM

Introduction

Federalism has long been a feature of several major industrial democracies such as Australia, Germany, the USA, India, and Brazil. The last quarter century has seen the adoption of federal arrangements or moves in the direction of federalism in many countries, including Belgium, Italy, Spain, the UK, and a number of 'third wave' democracies. European Union politics is also increasingly studied in reference to federalism. The concept of federalism is thus central to contemporary debates in political science. Those debates focus on three sorts of questions:

- *Why* are federal arrangements *adopted* and what determines their subsequent evolution?
 - Why have recent years seen adoption of federal arrangements and other forms of decentralization or 'multi-level governance' in a wide variety of countries? Is the evolution of federal arrangements the product of initial institutional design, elite interest calculation, popular pressure, or other factors?
- What different *forms* does federalism take?
 - Along what dimensions do federal systems vary? Can we generate a neat typology of federal systems? Should federalism be regarded as a special case of the more general phenomenon of 'multi-level governance'?
- What empirical *effects* follow from federalism?
 - Does federalism make policy-making easier or harder? Does it have positive effects, for example, for democracy, or for the economy, or for relations between ethnic groups within a country?

These three question types are related. Discussion of why federal arrangements are adopted has generally been 'functionalist', focusing on the effects they are intended to have. We typically study different forms of federalism in order to understand how they have different effects. In studying effects, we are centrally concerned with whether all forms of federalism have similar effects or not. The divisions among the readings below should thus be understood as very fluid.

Essay Questions

- What explains the adoption of federalist institutions?
- What are economic and political consequences of federalism and why?

Readings

Text book level introduction to the topic

- **Roberts Clark, W., Golder, M. and Golder, S. (2013) *Principles of Comparative Politics*. (Washington DC: CQ Press) **JF51.CLA**

- **Beramendi, P. (2007) 'Federalism' in *The Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch 31
 - This chapter gives an excellent overview of the rapidly expanding literature on the consequences of federalism and the problem of endogenous federal institutions.

- Galligan B. (2008) 'Comparative Federalism' in *The Oxford Handbook of Political Institutions* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch 14.
 - This chapter is a useful guide to key features of federal states.

Online

The Origins and Evolution of Federal Systems

For discussion of origins, see Riker and Stepan (both above), as well as newer contributions to the literature which see the choice of federal institutions as endogenous to pre-existing social and economic conditions.

- **Riker, W. (1975) 'Federalism', in Greenstein, F. and Polsby, N., eds., *Handbook of Political Science*, 5th ed (Reading, MA: Addison-Wesley) **JF51.GOV 1975**
 - A seminal text on the definition, origins, nature, and effects of federalism.

SOLO

- *Stepan, A. (2001) 'Toward a New Comparative Politics of Federalism, (Multi)Nationalism, and Democracy: Beyond Rikerian Federalism', in Stepan, *Arguing Comparative Politics* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) 315-361. **JF51.STE**
 - Response to Riker, looking at several dimensions of variation among federal systems and their effects for democracy and policy-making.

SOLO

- Ziblatt, D. (2004) 'Rethinking the Origins of Federalism: Puzzle, Theory, and Evidence from Nineteenth Century Europe' *World Politics*, 57(1), 70-98.

Online

- Kincaid, J. (2001) 'Economic Policy-Making: Advantages and Disadvantages of the Federal Model', *International Social Science Journal*, 53(167), 85-92.
 - Surveys pressures for federalism in light of economic globalization.

Online

The following two papers are part of an emerging literature which sees the choice of federal institutions as endogenous to pre-existing conditions.

- Wibbels, E. (2005) 'Decentralized governance, constitution formation and redistribution', *Constitutional Political Economy*, 16(2), 161-188.
 - Examines the effects of geographically salient factor endowments, inter-regional inequality, and intra-state inequality on constitutional negotiations in the US, Argentina and India.

Online

- Beramendi, P. (2007) 'Inequality and the Territorial Fragmentation of Solidarity', *International Organization*, 61, 783-820.
 - Argues that political choice between alternative fiscal structures is largely driven by their expected distributive consequences. As a result, the territorial structure of inequality becomes an important factor to explain why some fiscal structures are more integrated than others.

Online

For a discussion of the evolution of federal systems see:

- *Boone, C. (2003) 'Decentralization as Political Strategy in West Africa', *Comparative Political Studies*, 36(4), 355-380.

- On the complex politics shaping whether and how far decentralization occurs.

Online

- *Kelemen, R.D. (2003) 'The Structure and Dynamics of EU Federalism', *Comparative Political Studies*, 36(1/2), 184-208.

- Includes very useful discussion of the different accounts of evolution offered by the rational choice and constructivist (aka normative institutionalist) perspectives.

Online

- Eaton, K. (2006) 'Decentralization's Non-democratic Roots: Authoritarianism and Subnational Reform in Latin America' *Latin American Politics and Society*, 48(1), 1-27

- A highly original argument showing how authoritarian leaders are responsible for the decentralization often associated with liberalization and democratization.

Online

- *De Figueiredo R. and Weingast, B. (2005) 'Self-enforcing federalism', *Journal of Law Economics and Organization*, 21(1), 103-35.

- Endogeneity is at the core of recent efforts to understand the stability of federations. Formal theorists have addressed this problem by trying to establish when federal institutions become self-enforcing. This paper argues that in order to be self-enforcing federalism must give the center and the states incentives to fulfill their obligations within the limits of federal bargains.

Online

Forms of Federalism (and other types of multi-level governance)

Much discussion focuses on the distinction between two types of federalism: dual and cooperative though several authors contest its usefulness, or argue that we should broaden our thinking about 'multi-level governance'. A good starting point for considering the wider variety among federalisms is Stepan (above), see also:

- **Hooghe, L. and Marks, G. (2003) 'Unraveling the Central State, But How? Types of Multi-Level Governance', *American Political Science Review*, 97(2), 233-243.

- Argues that much more fluid forms of multi-level governance than traditional federalism are becoming increasingly common.

Online

- *Braun, D., Bullinger, A-B. and Wälti, S., (2002) 'The Influence of Federalism on Fiscal Policy Making', *European Journal of Political Research*, 41(1), 115-145.

- Discusses the differing effects of different federal arrangements.

Online

- Schneider, A. (2003) 'Decentralization: Conceptualization and measurement', *Studies in Comparative International Development*, 38(3), 32-56.

- Proposes a classification scheme of various forms of decentralization.

Online

The Effects of Federalism

A wide range of potential effects of federalism have been studied, most notably its effects on i) democratic stability, managing civil conflict and state survival: *LLL*

- **Baake. K.M. and Wibbels, E. (2006) 'Diversity, Disparity and Civil Conflict in Federal States,' *World Politics*, 59(2), 1-50.
 - Argues that the effects of federalism are shaped by a country's ethnic composition and income level

Online

- Amoretti and Bermeo eds. (2004) *Federalism and Territorial Cleavages* (Baltimore: Johns Hopkins), especially introduction by Amoretti and conclusion by Bermeo. **JC355.FED**

SOLO

- **Bermeo, N. (2002) 'A New Look at Federalism: The Import of Institutions,' *Journal of Democracy*, 13(2), 96-110.
 - Discusses whether federalism can successfully deal with inter-ethnic strife.

Online

- **Hale, H.E. (2004) 'Divided We Stand: Institutional Sources of Ethno-federal State Survival and Collapse,' *World Politics*, 56, 165-193

Online

- Brancati, D. (2006) 'Decentralization: Fueling the Fire or Dampening the Flames of Ethnic Conflict and Secessionism' *International Organization*, 60(3), 651-85
 - Discusses connections between federalism, party systems and levels of conflict.

Online

A second literature examines the effects of federalism on ii) economic outcomes, efficiency and effectiveness. This literature increasingly examines how the effects of federalism on economic outcomes are mediated by the strength of the national executive, the formal representation of subnational units within the national policy-making process and the organization of the party system.

- **Wibbels, E. (2000) 'Federalism and the Politics of Macroeconomic Policy and Performance,' *American Journal of Political Science*, 44(4), 687-702.
 - An important statistical test of the hypothesis that federal arrangements harm macroeconomic policy performance.

Online

- Kincaid, J. (2001) 'Economic Policy-Making: Advantages and Disadvantages of the Federal Model,' *International Social Science Journal*, 53(167), 85-92.
 - A brief survey of arguments in relation to economic policy.

Online

- *O'Dwyer, C. and Ziblatt, D. (2006) 'Does Decentralization Make Government More Efficient and Effective?', *Journal of Commonwealth and Comparative Politics*, 44(3), 326-343.
 - Use a broad cross-national sample to test decentralisation's relationship with two important indicators of the quality of governance: efficiency and effectiveness. They find that the effects of decentralisation are minimal when controlling for basic structural variables such as per capita GDP and degree of democracy, and

that different types of decentralisation - fiscal, administrative, and political - have differing and sometimes opposing impacts on the quality of governance.

Online

- *Rodden, J. and Wibbels, E. (2002) 'Beyond the fiction of federalism: macroeconomic management in multi-tiered systems', *World Politics*, 54(4), 494-531.
 - Use data on the budget balance and inflation in fifteen federations around the world from 1978 through 1996, and find that the effects of federalism on macroeconomic management are mediated by the level of fiscal decentralization, the nature of intergovernmental finance, and vertical partisan relations

Online

- Volden, C. (2002) 'The Politics of Competitive Federalism: A Race to the Bottom in Welfare Benefits?', *American Journal of Political Science*, 46(2), 352-363
 - Argues that competition between states in the US does not engender a race to the bottom. It does however cause states that wish to increase welfare to hesitate until neighboring states do the same.

Online

- Cai, H. and Teisman, D. (2004) 'State corroding federalism' *Journal of Public Economics*, 88, 819-43.
 - Argue that the effect of federalism on welfare is mediated by central law enforcement capacity. Where that capacity is weak interjurisdictional competition corrodes the state. They illustrate with three examples—from Russia, China, and the US—of cases in which such competition apparently encouraged subnational politicians to help firms evade central taxes or regulations.

Online

- Wachendorfer-Schmidt, U. ed. (2000) *Federalism and Political Performance* (London: Routledge) **JC355.FED**
 - See especially the introduction and conclusion that discuss a wide range of arguments for and against federalism

SOLO

Top

JUDICIARIES

Introduction

Judiciaries form a core component of a democratic state; they exert considerable, and in many states increasing, political influence. The major positive questions that we ask in relation to judiciaries are squarely related to normative questions concerning the democratic justification for political judging. Thus, we focus on three main (and inter-related) questions:

- Judicialisation. What do we mean by the *judicialisation of politics*? How widespread is the phenomenon, and what are its *causes*?
- How important are courts to democratic success and to 'output', and how do they sustain their political position and legitimacy?
- What is the *relationship* between (usually unelected) *judiciaries and elected political actors*?

The focus of studies that address such questions is almost always on the highest level courts in each state rather than on judicial systems as a whole, and this focus is reflected in the design of this topic.

Essay Questions

- In what sense are judges merely unelected legislators?
- Why have so many democratizing states adopted strong constitutional courts?

Readings

Text book level introduction to the topic

- **Roberts Clark, W., Golder, M. and Golder, S. (2013) *Principles of Comparative Politics*. (Washington DC: CQ Press) 634-648. **JF51.CLA**

SOLO

- **Ferejohn, J., Rosenbluth, F. and Shipan, C. (2007) 'Comparative Judicial Politics' *Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics*. (Oxford: Oxford University Press)
 - Focuses on judicial independence and the politics of the interaction between courts and other branches of government.

Online

- *Gibson, J.L. (2008) 'Judicial Institutions' in *The Oxford Handbook of Political Institutions* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch 26
 - Considers attitudinal, normative, strategic and institutional influences on judicial decision-making.

Online

- Shepsle K.A. and Bonchek, M.S. (1997) *Analyzing Politics* (London: W.W.Norton) Ch 15 **JA71.SHE**

SOLO

The Meaning of 'Judicialisation of Politics' and its Causes

- **Shapiro, M. and Stone Sweet, A. (2002) *On Law, Politics and Judicialization* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) **K370.SHA**
 - A collection of essays by two leading scholars including some very relevant essays (Esp. Chs. 1-3) on several aspects of judicialisation and the political roles of courts

SOLO

Online

- **Stone Sweet, A. (2000) *Governing with Judges: Constitutional Politics in Europe* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) **KJC5456.STO**
 - The 'European' (Kelsen) model of constitutional review, assessed in a complex conceptual framework. Stone Sweet introduces the idea that judiciaries are the third chamber of the legislature in many cases.

SOLO

Online

- *Tate, C.N. and Vallinder, T. eds. (1995) *The Global Expansion of Judicial Power* (New York: NYU Press) **K3367.GLO**
 - A set of essays defining and exploring aspects of judicialisation

SOLO

- *Guarnieri, C. and Pederzoli, P. (2002) *The Power of Judges: A Comparative Study of Courts and Democracy* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Introduction and Ch. 3 **K2100.GUA**
 - Comparative study of judicialisation, drawing on seven European and American cases.

SOLO

- Epp, C.R. (1998) *The Rights Revolution: Lawyers, Activists and Supreme Courts in Comparative Perspective* (Chicago: The University of Chicago Press) **K3240.4.EPP**
 - The role of collective action in judicialisation in common-law systems.

SOLO

- Garrett, G., Kelemen, R.D. and Schulz, H. (1998) 'The European Court of Justice, National Governments, and Legal Integration in the European Union', *International Organization*, 52(1), 149-176.
 - Develops a rational choice account of judicialisation, with potential application to many cases besides the ECJ.

Online

- Romeu, F.R. (2006) 'The Establishment of Constitutional Courts: A Study of 128 Democratic Constitutions', *Review of Law and Economics*, 1, 104-135.

Online

- Volcansek, M.L. ed. (1992) *Judicial politics and policy-making in Western Europe* (London: Cass) **KJC3666.JUD**

SOLO

- *Democratization* 10(4) (Winter 2003) - Special Issue on 'Democratization and the Judiciary: The Accountability Function of Courts in New Democracies.'

Online

- Navia, P. and Ríos-Figueroa, J. (2005) 'The Constitutional Adjudication Mosaic of Latin America', *Comparative Political Studies*, 38(2), 189-217.

Online

Performance, Legitimacy and Outcomes

- LaPorta, R. et al. (2003) 'Judicial checks and balances' *National Bureau of Economic Research*, No. w9775.
 - An empirical examination of the positive effects of judicial independence and constitutional review on economic freedom.

Online

- Lane, J-E. and Ersson, S. (2000) 'Judicial Institutions', in Lane and Ersson, *The New Institutional Politics: Performance and Outcomes* (London: Routledge) **JF51.LAN**
 - A short, succinct chapter addressing some simple questions about the consequences of judicial review.

SOLO

- Gibson, J.L., Caldeira, G.A. and Baird, V.A. (1998) 'On the Legitimacy of National High Courts', *American Political Science Review*, 92(2), 343-358.
 - A useful analysis of variation in support for constitutional courts.

Online

- Rosenberg, G. (2008) *The Hollow Hope: Can Courts Bring About Social Change?* 2nd ed (Chicago: The University of Chicago Press) **KF8700.ROS**
 - A US study rejecting the notion that, even in a highly judicialized polity, courts can exert much influence on public policy

SOLO

The Relationship between Courts and Other Institutions

In the literature on judicial institutions, too, the question how and why particular judicial institutions are chosen is relevant – institutional choices, in other words, may need to be thought of as endogenous:

- Ginsburg, T. (2002) "Economic Analysis and the Design of Constitutional Courts" *Theoretical Inquiries in Law*, 3(1), 2-38.

Online

- Epstein, L., Knight, J. and Schvetsova, O. (2002) 'Selecting Selection Systems' in Burbank, S. and Friedman, B. *Judicial Independence at the Crossroads: An Interdisciplinary Approach*. (Thousand Oaks CA: Sage Publications) 191-226. **KF8775.JUD**

SOLO

- Williams, Matthew. 2018. *How language works in politics: The Impact of Vague Legislation on Policy*: University of Chicago. Chapters 6,7.

Rational choice theorists have attempted to provide general models of the influence of judiciaries on the policy-making process. These accounts generally see judges as strategic actors who realize that their ability to achieve their policy and other goals depends on the preferences of other actors, the choices they expect others to make, and the institutional context in which they act.

- **Tsebelis, G. (2002) *Veto Players: How Political Institutions Work* (Princeton: Princeton University Press) Ch. 10. **JF51.TSE**

SOLO

- *Vanberg, G. (2001) 'Legislative-Judicial Relations: A Game-Theoretic Approach to Constitutional Review', *American Journal of Political Science*, 45(2), 346-361.

Online

- Segal, J. (1997) 'Separation-of-Powers Games in the Positive Theory of Congress and Courts', *American Political Science Review*, 91(1), 28-44.

Online

Studies of the impact of courts in different political contexts:

These studies examine why politicians often support strong courts.

- *Hirschl, R. (2008) 'The Judicialization of Politics' in *The Oxford Handbook of Law and Politics* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) Ch 8.
 - Hirschl argues that politicians have, in some cases, deliberately empowered judges to preserve their hegemony.

Online

- Dotan, Y. and Menachem, H. (2005) 'Legal Defeats—Political Wins: Why Do Elected Representatives Go to Court?', *Comparative Political Studies*, 38(1), 75-103.

Online

Courts make decisions that impact on politics in a variety of different political contexts and under surprisingly divergent conditions – for instance judicial independence is not necessarily a precondition for judicial influence on politics:

- **Carrubba, C.J., Gabel, M. and Hankla, C. (2008) 'Judicial Behavior under Political Constraints: Evidence from the European Court of Justice' *American Political Science Review*, 102(4), 435-452.

Online

- *Herron, E. and Randazzo, K. (2003) 'The Relationship Between Independence and Judicial Review in Post-Communist Courts', *Journal of Politics*, 65, 422-38.

Online

- *Voeten, E. (2008) 'The Impartiality of International Judges: Evidence from the European Court of Human Rights' *American Political Science Review*, 102(4), 417-433.

Online

- Bell, J. (2006) *Judiciaries within Europe* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **KJC3716.BEL**

SOLO

- Dyevre, A. (2010) 'Unifying the field of comparative judicial politics: towards a general theory of judicial behaviour', *ECPR*, 2(2), 297-327.
- Hönnige, C. (2011) 'Beyond Judicialization: why we need more comparative research about constitutional courts', *EPS*, 10(3), 346-358.

- Williams, M. (2017) 'Legislative language and judicial politics: The effects of changing parliamentary language on UK immigration disputes', BJPIR, 19(3), 592–608.



INTEREST GROUPS

Introduction

Interest groups are crucially important links between the state and society. Political scientists have studied them both extensively and intensively, and have evaluated them in strikingly divergent ways. Some scholars have argued that interest groups are essential to political representation, but others that they risk subverting it. Some have argued that interest groups enhance the accountability of governments to voters, but others that they obscure it. Some have identified the empowerment of minorities as being groups' decisive advantage in democratic political systems where minority rights risk being marginalized, but others have seen such empowerment as comprising an illegitimate threat to democratic majorities.

As is the case in other topics in *Comparative Government*, academic debates concerning interest groups raise normative questions of fundamental importance not only for scholars but for citizens in democracies about:

- the fact or fiction of resource equality and its significance for politics and government;
- what the relationship between the state and society should and should not be;
- the actual and desirable location and distribution of political power;
- the actual and desirable transparency and quality of participation in policy-making;
- the extent and depth of individual and group participation in the making of public policy, not just within states but between them (as, for example, in international debates about environmental and human rights policy).

Within the interest groups topic in this course, we channel these questions into two broad areas:

- The '*collective action problem*' also referred to as the '*logic of collective action*'. What is the collective action problem? What does it imply about the relationship between interest groups and their actual or potential members? What does it imply about the distribution of power across interest groups, and with what implications for policy outcomes? How can the problems associated with it be addressed?
- The *interaction between interest groups and the state: corporatism and pluralism*. How do interest groups and the state interact? What are the strengths and weaknesses of theories of corporatism and policy networks? What are the implications for the nature of policy and the quality of the democratic process?

Essay Questions

- Why has it proved difficult to formulate general comparative conclusions about interest groups?
- To what extent does the literature on the 'logic of collective action' explain the distribution of power within and between interests? Readings

Text book level introduction to the topic

- *Shepsle, K.A. and Bonchek, M.S. (1997) *Analyzing Politics* (London: W.W.Norton) Ch 9
JA71.SHE

- *Dunleavy, P. (1991) *Democracy, Bureaucracy and Public Choice: Economic Explanations in Political Science* (New York: Harvester Wheatsheaf) Chs. 2 and 3. **JA77.DUN**

SOLO

- McFarland, A. (2010) 'Interest Group Politics' in Sandy, M.L. and Barry, J.M. eds. *The Oxford Handbook of American Political Parties and Interest Groups* (Oxford: Oxford University Press)
 - This is a US-centric study but begins with useful theoretical material on interest group politics, discussing the major scholars in the field.

Online

- **McAdam, D., Tarrow S. and Tilly C. (2009) 'Comparative Perspectives on Contentious Politics' in Lichbach and Zuckerman eds. *Comparative Politics: Rationality, Culture and Structure*. (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Ch. 10 **JA86.COM**
 - Gives an excellent overview of the development of literature on strikes, social movements, rebellions and civil war, which overlaps with work on interest groups.

SOLO

- **Beyers, J., Eising, R. and Maloney, W. (2008) 'Researching Interest Group Politics in Europe and Elsewhere: Much We Study, Little We Know?', *West European Politics*, 31(6), 1103-1128.
 - This article reviews developments in European studies of interest groups and advocates a comparative approach.

Online

- *Hacker, J.S. and Pierson, P. (2014) "After the "Master Theory": Downs, Schattschneider, and the Rebirth of Policy-Focused Analysis." *Perspectives on Politics* 12(3): 643-662.

The Formation of Interest Groups: The Collective Action Problem

Not all interests that could potentially organise as interest groups do. One reason may be the collective action problem, which was originally identified by Olson in the 1960s. One of the central questions for the study of interest groups since then has been whether and how interest groups are able to overcome that problem, and with what implications for the nature of policy and the balance of power in society. To begin, see:

- **Olson, M. (1971) *The Logic of Collective Action: Public Goods and the Theory of Groups* (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press) **HM131.OLS**

SOLO

On the collective action problem:

- **Green, D.P. and Shapiro, I. (1994) *Pathologies of Rational Choice Theory* (New Haven: Yale University Press) Ch 5: 'Social Dilemmas and Free-Riding' **JA73.GRE**

SOLO

- Moe, T. (1980) *The Organization of Interests: Incentives and the Internal Dynamics of Political Interest Groups* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press). **JF529.MOE**
 - Seeks to expand Olson's argument to provide a richer account of the operation and effects of interest group organization.

SOLO

- Kimber, R. (1993) 'Interest Groups and the Fallacy of the Liberal Fallacy', in Richardson, J.J., ed., *Pressure Groups* (Oxford: Oxford University Press) 38-47 **JF529.PRE**
 - Critiques the logic of Olson's argument.

SOLO

- Ahlquist, J., & Levi, M. (2013). *In the interest of others*. Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press (esp. Ch. 1, 3, 4, and pp. 57 to 60 in Ch. 2). **E-book on Solo and HD8031.AHL 2013 (SSL)**
 - Investigates why and how some interest groups expand their scope of action and engage in political actions that do not benefit their members directly.

- Esteban, J. and Ray, D. (2001) 'Collective Action and the Group Size Paradox', *American Political Science Review*, 95(3), 663-672.

Online

- McFarland, A.S. (1991) 'Interest Groups and Political Time: Cycles in America', *British Journal of Political Science*, 21(3), 257-284.
 - Argues that the differential effects of the logic of collective action across groups imply a cycle of policy influence.

Online

- McLean, I. (2000) 'Review Article: The Divided Legacy of Mancur Olson', *British Journal of Political Science*, 30(4), 651-668.
 - Wide-ranging review of Olson's work.

Online

On the emergence of interest groups see:

- Crowley, J.E. and Skocpol, T. (2001) 'The Rush to Organize: Explaining Associational Formation in the United States, 1860s-1920s', *American Journal of Political Science*, 45(4), 813-829.

Online

- Tichenor, D.J. and Harris, R.A. (2005) 'The Development of Interest Group Politics in America: Beyond the Conceits of Modern Times', *Annual Review Political Science*, 8, 251-270.

Online

Variation in interest group influence

On corporatism's rise and decline

One strand of theory prominent in the 1970s and 1980s challenged the theoretical dominance of the collective action problem, holding that it was overcome by corporatist relations between the state and major societal interests such as capital, labour, and agriculture:

- Berger, S. ed. (1981) *Organizing Interests in Western Europe: Pluralism, Corporatism, and the Transformation of Politics* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press). **JN94.A792.ORG**
 - See in particular the introduction, on debates between pluralism and corporatism.

SOLO

- Crepaz, M. (1992) 'Corporatism in Decline?: An Empirical Analysis of the Impact of Corporatism on Macroeconomic Performance and Industrial Disputes in 18 Industrialized Democracies', *Comparative Political Studies*, 25(2), 139-168.

Online

- Schmitter, P.C. and Lehmbruch, G. (1979) *Trends Towards Corporatist Intermediation* (London: SAGE) Ch. 1. **JC478.TRE**
 - Includes classic definitions of key terms in the debate between pluralism and corporatism.

SOLO

On political opportunity structures

- ****Lijphart, A. (1999) *Patterns of Democracy: Government Forms and Performance in Thirty-Six Countries* (New Haven: Yale University Press) Ch 9 **JC421.LIJ****

SOLO

- ***Kriesi, H. et.al. (1992) 'New social movements and political opportunities in Western Europe', *European Journal of Political Research*, 219-244.**

Online

Policy Networks and New Governance

As corporatist relations have been (on some accounts) shattered by state-sponsored revivals of markets through privatization, the de-privileging of trade unions, and contracting-out, attention has shifted from the static character of corporatism to the more fluid nature of policy-making. There, analysis of policy-making through frameworks including policy networks, policy communities, and epistemic communities have facilitated dynamic analyses of what it is that interest groups do to shape public policy. For an introduction to this literature, see:

- Kriesi, H., Adam, S. and Jochum, M. (2006) 'Comparative analysis of policy networks in Western Europe', *Journal of European Public Policy*, 13(3), 341-361.

Online

- Marsh, D. (1998) *Comparing Policy Networks* (Buckingham: Open University Press) **H96.COM**

SOLO

- Rhodes, R.A.W. and Marsh, D. (1992) 'New Directions in the Study of Policy Networks', *European Journal of Political Research*, 21(1-2), 181-205.
 - Sets out a typology of policy networks.

Online

- Rhodes, R.A.W. (1997) *Understanding Governance: Policy Networks, Governance, Reflexivity and Accountability* (Buckingham: Open University Press) Ch. 2 and 3 **JN231.RHO**
 - Ch 2 Discusses the relationship between the networks approach and earlier work on pluralism and corporatism; outlines several typologies of policy networks.
 - Ch 3 Discusses how changes in the nature of the UK state have altered the relationship between state and non-state actors.

SOLO

Further reading:

- *Béland, D., Rocco P., and Waddan, A. (2019) “Policy Feedback and the Politics of the Affordable Care Act.” *Policy Studies Journal* 47(2): 395-422.
- *Cigler, A.J., Burdett A. and Loomis, B.A. (2007) *Interest Group Politics*, 7th ed (Washington Press) **JK1118.INT**

- Dowding, K. (1995) ‘Model or Metaphor? A Critical Review of the Policy Network Approach’, *Political Studies*, 43(1), 136-158.
 - A highly critical response to the networks literature.
- *Flöthe, L. (2019) “The Cost of Interest Representation. A Resource Perspective on Informational Lobbying.” *European Political Science Review* 11(2): 161-178.
- Thatcher, M. (1998) ‘The Development of Policy Network Analyses’, *Journal of Theoretical Politics*, 10(4), 389-416.
 - A critical overview of the literature.
- Heclo, H. (1978) ‘Issue Networks and the Executive Establishment’, in Anthony King, A., ed., *The New American Political System*, 1st ed (Washington DC: American Enterprise Institute for Public Policy Research) 87-124. **JK1717.NEW**
 - Seminal text in the US literature. Note that it does not appear in the 2nd edition.
- Baumgartner, F.R. and Jones, B.D. (1991) ‘Agenda Dynamics and Policy Sub-Systems’, *Journal of Politics*, 53(4), 1044-1074.
 - Focuses on the factors that shape policy networks and how this process influences policy outcomes.


CLIENTELISM

General Information

In democracies and non-democracies across the developing world, politicians deploy many tactics to win votes, and electoral competition is often not solely about the policies competing parties and politicians promise. This lecture introduces students to the dynamics of one widespread form of non-programmatic electioneering: the particularistic exchange of gifts and favours for electoral support, or clientelism. While such exchanges may violate the principle that individuals should be free from manipulation and pressure in making their vote choice, and may even be illegal, they have been used practically around the world, in democratic as well as non-democratic states. Yet, they are not present everywhere, and may not be equally prevalent in all the contexts where the practice exists. The following are some of the questions explored in the lecture and in the readings: What is clientelism? How do the types of linkages established via these exchanges differ from programmatic, personalistic or ethnic electoral connections? How does vote buying work? What resources must parties deploy in order to make vote buying effective? How do parties and politicians decide whether or not to try and buy votes, and which voters to target? Under which conditions is clientelism more likely to emerge or subside? What are its implications for the quality of electoral competition? How do citizens evaluate clientelistic practices?

Essay Questions

- Does clientelism benefit the poor?
- Under what conditions is vote buying more likely to emerge?

Introductory Readings

What is clientelism? How does it differ from other types of electoral strategies? What is vote buying?

- **Kitchelt, H. (2000) 'Linkages Between Citizens and Politicians in Democratic Politics', *Comparative Political Studies*, 33(6-7), 845-879

Online

- **Stokes, S. (2007) 'Political Clientelism' in Boix, C. and Stokes, S. eds., *The Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics*. (Oxford: Oxford University Press)

Online

- *Hicken, A. (2011) 'Clientelism', *Annual Review of Political Science*, 14, 289-310

Online

- *Stokes, S. et al. (2013) *Brokers, Voters and Clientelism: The Puzzle of Distributive Politics*. (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Ch 1. **JF1525.P6.STO**

SOLO

- *Isabela Mares and Lauren Young. 2016. 'Buying, Expropriating, and Stealing Votes,' *Annual Review of Political Science*
- Isabela Mares and Lauren Young. 2019. *Conditionality & Coercion: Electoral clientelism in Eastern Europe*. Oxford University Press. (chapter 1)

How does vote buying work? Who do parties target? Is it always rational to use vote buying during campaigns? Is monitoring vote choice necessary for the success of clientelistic exchanges?

- Stokes, S. (2005) 'Perverse Accountability: A Formal Model of Machine Politics with Evidence from Argentina', *American Political Science Review*, 99(3), 315-325

Online

- Nichter, S. (2008) 'Vote Buying or Turnout Buying? Machine Politics and the Secret Ballot', *American Political Science Review*, 102(1), 19-31

Online

- Stokes, S. et al. (2013) *Brokers, Voters and Clientelism: The Puzzle of Distributive Politics* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Ch 4. **JF1525.P6.STO**

SOLO

- Gonzalez Ocantos, .E. et al. (2012) 'Vote Buying and Social Desirability Bias: Experimental Evidence from Nicaragua', *American Journal of Political Science*, 56(1), 202-217

Online

- Szwarberg, M. (2012) 'Uncertainty, Political Clientelism, and Voter Turnout in Latin America: Why Parties Conduct Rallies in Argentina', *Comparative Politics*, 45(1), 88-106

Online

- Munoz, P. (2014) 'An Informational Theory of Campaign Clientelism: The Case of Peru', *Comparative Politics*, 47(1), 79-98

Online

- Lawson, C. and Greene, K. (2014) 'Making Clientelism Work: How Norms of Reciprocity Increase Voter Compliance', *Comparative Politics*, 47(1), 61-85

Online

- Rueda, Miguel R. 2017. 'Small Aggregates, Big Manipulation: Vote Buying Enforcement and Collective Monitoring'. *American Journal of Political Science* 61 (1): 163–77.

- Cruz, Cesi. 2019. 'Social Networks and the Targeting of Vote Buying'. *Comparative Political Studies* 52 (3): 382–411.

- Finan, Frederico, and Laura Schechter. 2012. 'Vote-Buying and Reciprocity'. *Econometrica* 80 (2): 863–81.

- **Munoz, P. (2014) 'An Informational Theory of Campaign Clientelism: The Case of Peru', *Comparative Politics*, 47(1), 79-98

- *Lawson, C. and Greene, K. (2014) 'Making Clientelism Work: How Norms of Reciprocity Increase Voter Compliance', *Comparative Politics*, 47(1), 61-85

- *Kramon, Eric. 2016. 'Electoral Handouts as Information'. *World Politics* 68 (03): 454–98.

Under what conditions are clientelistic linkages more likely to emerge? What explains the rise and fall of clientelistic networks?

- Scott, J. (1969) 'Corruption, Machine Politics, and Political Change', *American Political Science Review*, 63, 1142–58

Online

- Shefter, M. (1994) *Political Parties and the State: The American Historical Experience* (Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press) Chs 2 and 7

SOLO

Online

- *Kitchelt, H. and Wilkinson, S. (2007) 'Citizen-Politician Linkages: An Introduction' in Kitchelt, H. and Wilkinson, S. eds. *Patrons, Clients and Policies: Patterns of Democratic Accountability and Political Competition* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JF2111.PAT**

SOLO

- *Kitschelt, Herbert, and Daniel M. Kselman. 2012. 'Economic Development, Democratic Experience, and Political Parties' Linkage Strategies'. *Comparative Political Studies* 46 (11): 1453–84.

- Weitz-Shapiro, R. (2012) 'What Wins Votes: Why Some Politicians Opt Out of Clientelism', *American Journal of Political Science*, 56(3), 568-583.

Online

- Hale, H. (2007) 'Correlates of Clientelism: Political Economy, Politicized Ethnicity and Post-Communist Transition' in Kitchelt, H. and Wilkinson, S. eds. *Patrons, Clients and Policies: Patterns of Democratic Accountability and Political Competition* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JF2111.PAT**

SOLO

- Kitchelt, H. (2007) 'The Demise of Clientelism in Affluent Capitalist Democracies' in Kitchelt, H. and Wilkinson, S. eds. *Patrons, Clients and Policies: Patterns of Democratic Accountability and Political Competition* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JF2111.PAT**

SOLO

- Stokes, S. et al. (2013) *Brokers, Voters and Clientelism: The Puzzle of Distributive Politics* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Ch 8. **JF1525.P6.STO**

SOLO

- Berenschot, Ward. 2018. 'The Political Economy of Clientelism: A Comparative Study of Indonesia's Patronage Democracy'. *Comparative Political Studies* 51 (12): 1563–93.

Clientelism in non-democratic regimes

- **Lehoucq, F. (2003) 'Electoral Fraud: Causes, Types and Consequences', *Annual Review of Political Science*, 6, 233-256

Online

- Blaydes, L. (2010) *Elections and Distributive Politics in Mubarak's Egypt* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) Chs 6 and 7. **JQ3892.BLA**

SOLO

- Gonzalez Ocantos, E., Kiewiet de Jonge, C. and Nickerson, D. (2015) 'Legitimacy Buying: The Dynamics of Clientelism in the Face of Legitimacy Challenges', *Comparative Political Studies*

Online

- *Frye, Timothy, Ora John Reuter, and David Szakonyi. 2019. 'Vote Brokers, Clientelist Appeals, and Voter Turnout: Evidence from Russia and Venezuela'. *World Politics* 71 (04): 710–46.

Does vote buying "work?"

- *Wantchenkon, L. (2003) 'Clientelism and Voting Behavior: Evidence from A Field Experiment in Benin', *World Politics*, 55(3), 399-422

Online

- Larreguy, Horacio, John Marshall, and Pablo Querubín. 2016. 'Parties, Brokers, and Voter Mobilization: How Turnout Buying Depends Upon the Party's Capacity to Monitor Brokers'. *American Political Science Review* 110 (01): 160–79.
- Munoz, Paula. (2019) *Buying Audiences: Clientelism and Electoral Campaigns When Parties Are Weak*. Cambridge University Press. Chapters 2-3.
- *Greene, Kenneth. (2020) 'Campaign Effects and the Elusive Swing Voter in Modern Machine Politics.' *Comparative Political Studies*

What are the implications of clientelism for democratic quality? How do citizens evaluate the consequences of vote buying?

- *Auyero, J. (2000) 'The Logic of Clientelism in Argentina: An Ethnographic Account', *Latin American Research Review*, 35(3), 55-81

Online

- Baldwin, Kate. 2013. 'Why Vote with the Chief? Political Connections and Public Goods Provision in Zambia.' *American Journal of Political Science* 57 (4): 794–809.
- *Auerbach, Adam Michael, and Tariq Thachil. 2018. 'How Clients Select Brokers: Competition and Choice in India's Slums'. *American Political Science Review* 112 (04): 775–91.
- Borges Martins da Silva, Mariana. Forthcoming. 'Weapons of Clients: Why Do Voters Support Bad Patrons? Ethnographic Evidence from Rural Brazil'. *Latin American Politics and Society*. Available: https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=3956810
- Stokes, S. (2007) 'Is Vote Buying Undemocratic?' Schaffer, F. ed. *Elections for Sale: The Causes and Consequences of Vote Buying* (Boulder, CO: Lynne Rienner Publishers) **JF1083.ELE**

SOLO

DEMOCRATIC OUTCOMES

Having gone through some different types of democratic institutions, we now are in position to address a more fundamental question that transcends the whole paper: Leaving aside normative views about civil rights and liberties, what difference does democracy make? Does democracy outperform other regimes when it comes to political and economic outcomes? For example, does democracy produce wealth more so than authoritarianism? Are more public services provided in democracies than other regimes? We will try to answer these questions by focusing on the outcomes of democracy, and by unpacking the mechanisms driving the potential effects of regime types.

Essay Questions

- Do democracies outperform autocracies in terms of social equality, human development, and the delivery of welfare services?
- Is economic growth higher under democracy?

Introductory textbook level readings

- **Sen, A. (2000) 'The Importance of Democracy' in *Development as Freedom* (New York: Anchor Books) 146-159. **JC585.SEN**
 Classic account of the political and economic benefits of democracy.
- Dahl, R.A., Shapiro, I. and Cheibub, J. A., *The Democracy Sourcebook* (Cambridge, MA: MIT Press). Chapter 8 "Democracy's Effects". JC423.DEM

Democracy and Growth

Do democracies outperform non-democratic regimes in economic development? If so, what explains this difference? What mechanisms make democratic regimes more efficient in their economic performance? The following references address these questions both from a theoretical and an empirical perspective. In so doing, they also distinguish between varieties of welfare regimes.

- *Acemoglu, D. et al. (2104). 'Democracy Does Cause Growth.' *NBER Working Paper Series*.
- Madsen, J. B., Raschky, P. A., & Skali, A. (2015). Does democracy drive income in the world, 1500–2000? *European Economic Review*, 78, 175-195.
- *Engerman, S.L. and Sokoloff, K.L. (2008) 'Debating the role of institutions in political and economic development: Theory, history, and findings', *Annual Review Of Political Science*, 11, 119-135.
 - An overview of the role of representative institutions in growth and other macroeconomic indicators
- Glaeser, E.L., La Porta, R., Lopez-de-Silanes, F. and Shleifer, A. (2004) 'Do institutions cause growth?', *Journal Of Economic Growth*, 9(3), 271-303
 - They challenge scholarly wisdom suggesting that human capital is a more basic source of growth than institutions and that poor countries get out of poverty through good policies, often pursued by dictators; they subsequently improve their political institutions

 Online

- Papaioannou, E. and Siourounis, G. (2008). 'Democratisation and growth', *Economic Journal*, vol. 118(532), pp. 1520–51.
- Dincecco, M. and G. Katz (2016) 'State Capacity and Long-Run Economic Performance', *The Economic Journal*, 126(590), pp. 189–218.
- Kriekhaus, J. (2006) 'Democracy and economic growth: How regional context influences regime effects', *British Journal of Political Science*, 36(2), 317-340.
- Rodrik, D., A. Subramanian and F. Trebbi. (2004). "Institutions Rule: The Primacy of Institutions over Geography and Integration in Economic Development." *Journal of Economic Growth* 9(2):131–165.
- Cox, G. W., & Weingast, B. R. (2018). Executive constraint, political stability, and economic growth. *Comparative Political Studies*, 51(3), 279-303.
- Martinez, L. R. (2022). 'How Much Should We Trust the Dictator's GDP Growth Estimates?' *Journal of Political Economy*, 130(10).

Democracy and well-being

The democratic state is expected to perform better in the provision of public goods. But is there empirical evidence supporting this claim? The literature, as shown below, seems to provide a more nuanced perspective in the comparison between democratic and non-democratic regimes.

- Harding, R. and Wantchekon, L. (2010) 'The Political Economy of Human Development', *Human Development Research Papers*, UNDP.
- *Ross, M. (2006) 'Is democracy good for the poor?', *American Journal of Political Science*, 50(4), 860-874.
 - Challenges the view that democracies have any effect on infant and child mortality rates.

Online

- Lake, D.A. and Baum, M.A. (2001) 'The invisible hand of democracy - Political control and the provision of public services', *Comparative Political Studies*, 34(6), 587-621

Online

- Mulligan, C.B., Gil, R. and Sala-i-Martin, X. (2004) 'Do democracies have different public policies than non-democracies?', *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 18(1), 51-74.

Online

- Kudamatsu, M. (2012). 'Has Democratization Reduced Infant Mortality in Sub-Saharan Africa? Evidence from Micro Data.' *Journal of the European Economic Association*, 10(6), 1294-1317.

- Stroup, M.D. (2006) 'Economic freedom, democracy, and the quality of life', *World Development*, 35(1), 52-66.

Online

- Przeworski, A., Alvarez, M.E., Cheibub, J.A. and Limongi, F. (2000) *Democracy and Development: Political Institutions and Well-Being in the World, 1950-1990*. Chs 2 and 3. **JC423.DEM**

SOLO

- Nelson, J. M. (2007). "Elections, Democracy, and Social Services." *Studies in Comparative International Development*, 41(4), 79—97.
- Miller, M. K. (2015). Electoral Authoritarianism and Human Development. *Comparative Political Studies*, 48(12), 1526—1562.
- Harding, Robin (2020) 'Who is Democracy Good For? Elections, Rural Bias, and Health and Education Outcomes in Sub-Saharan Africa', *Journal of Politics*, 82(1).
- Burgess, R., Jedwab, R., Miguel, E., Morjaria, A., & Padró i Miquel, G. (2015). 'The value of democracy: evidence from road building in Kenya'. *American Economic Review*, 105(6), 1817-51.
- Fujiwara, T. (2015). 'Voting technology, political responsiveness, and infant health: Evidence from Brazil'. *Econometrica*, 83(2), 423-464.

Democracy and Education

Various studies have investigated the relationship between democracies, welfare state and the expansion of national education systems throughout the 20th century.

- Ansell, B. and Lindvall, J. (2013) 'The political origins of primary education systems: Ideology, institutions, and interdenominational conflict in an era of nation-building.' *American Political Science Review*, 107(3), 505-522.
 - The article discusses the role of democracy on the centralization, secularization and subsidiarization of primary education systems.

Online

- Stasavage, D. (2005) 'Democracy and education spending in Africa', *American Journal of Political Science*, 49 (2), 343-358.
 - The article provides theory and evidence showing that the need to obtain an electoral majority may have prompted African governments to spend more on education and to prioritize primary schools over universities within the education budget.

Online

- Harding, R. and Stasavage, D. (2014) 'What Democracy Does (and Doesn't) Do for Basic Services: School Fees, School Inputs, and African Elections.' *The Journal of Politics*, 76(1), 229-245.
- Dahlum, S. and C. H. Knutsen (2017). "Do Democracies Provide Better Education? Revisiting the Democracy-Human Capital Link." *World Development*, 94, 186—199.

Democracy and Redistribution

A key question among social scientists is whether democratic systems spend more on welfare and if so, why they do so. The following studies focus on both questions and in so doing they shed light on the mechanics of government under democratic and non-democratic rule.

- Acemoglu, D. et al. (2013). 'Democracy, Redistribution, and Inequality.' National Bureau of Economic Research: working paper no. 19746.
- Boix, C. (2001). 'Democracy, Development, and the Public Sector', *American Journal of political Science*, 45(1), 1-17.
- Brown, D.S. (1999) 'Democracy and social spending in Latin America, 1980-92', *American Political Science Review*, 93, 779.
 - The article shows that in poor countries during economic crisis, democracies increase the allocation of resources to social programs relative to authoritarian regimes.

Online

- Knutsen, C. H. and Wegmann, S. (2015) 'Is Democracy about Redistribution?' *Democratization*, 23(1).
- Fails, Matthew. (2020) 'Are electoral autocracies better for the poor? Evidence from social assistance programs', *Research and Politics* [online]

CONSTITUTIONS

Imagine you have to draft a constitution for a new country. How would you like your country to look like? What form of government would you give to your country? Would you go for a proportional or a majoritarian system? Would you opt for a federal or a unitary structure? All these issues need to be considered under the light of what a constitution is and what purpose it serves.

Essay questions

- 'Small constitutions are better than longer constitutions.' Discuss.
- Should constitutions be easily amendable?

Introductory Readings

An excellent introduction to constitutional theory:

- *Lane, J-E., (1996) *Constitutions and Political Theory* (Manchester: Manchester University Press) **JF51.LAN**

SOLO

A slightly more technical but extremely insightful theoretical account on modern constitution building:

- Horowitz, D.L. (2002) 'Constitutional Design: Proposals versus Processes' in Reynolds, A. ed. *The Architecture of Democracy: Constitutional Design, Conflict Management, and Democracy* (Oxford: Oxford University Press), 15-36. **JC421.ARC**

SOLO

Online

For some applied constitutional theory:

- Castiglione, D. (2005) 'Did Europe Need a Constitution? Between Facts and Theories' *European Political Science*
 - At the cutting edge of constitutional scholarship are those concerned with the authorship of the European Constitutional Treaty. This review article looks at the major theoretical and practical difficulties faced by this venture.

Online

- Arjomand, S.A. ed. (2007) *Constitutionalism and political reconstruction* (Boston: Brill) **JF51.CON**

- Shows the importance of constitutions in state building and democratic reconstruction of post-communist countries.

SOLO

Online

Two classic accounts of forward-looking constitution engineering:

- Banting, K. and Simeon, R. ed. (1985) *Redesigning the State* (Toronto: Univ. of Toronto Press) **K3168.BAN**

SOLO

- Buchanan, J.M. and Tullock, M. (1962) *The Calculus of Consent* (Indianapolis, IN: Liberty Fund) **JC423.BUC**

SOLO

Political constraints in Constitution building:

- Elster, J. (1995) 'Forces and Mechanisms in the Constitution-Making Process', *Duke Law Journal*, 45, 364-396.

Online

- Bologna Pavlik, J. and Young, A.T. (2025) "Public participation and constitutional compliance", *American Journal of Political Science*, available [online](#).

A set of case studies illustrating the considerations while drafting a new constitution:

- Samuels, K. (2007) 'Constitution building processes and democratization: A discussion of twelve case studies', *International IDEA*.

Online

Models of the Political System

Arend Lijphart has developed three very influential models of government: the Westminster, consensus, and consociational models:

- *Lijphart, A. (2008) *Thinking About Democracy: Power Sharing and Majority Rule in Theory and Practice* (London: Routledge) **JC423.LIJ**
 - This recent collection of Lijphart's essays covers all of his major contributions to the field. The most significant individual contributions can be found in the following readings.

SOLO

- Lijphart, A. (2012) *Patterns of Democracy: Government Forms and Performance in Thirty-Six Countries* (New Haven: Yale UP). **JC421.LIJ**
 - Outlines the majoritarian and consensus models.

SOLO

- Lijphart, A. (1996) 'The Puzzle of Indian Democracy: A Consociational Interpretation', *American Political Science Review*, 90(2), 258-268.
 - A contentious application of the concept of consociationalism to a problematic case.

Online

Other studies of the effects of constitutional structures as an interlinked system include:

- *Sartori, G. (2002) *Comparative Constitutional Engineering: An Inquiry into Structures, Incentives and Outcomes*, 2nd ed. (Basingstoke: Palgrave) **JF51.SAR**

SOLO

- Baaklini, A.I. and Desfosses, H. eds. (1997) *Designs for Democratic Stability: Studies in Viable Constitutionalism* (London: M.E. Sharpe) **JF51.DES**

- This book includes a valuable discussion of the 'Westminster model' away from Westminster.

SOLO

- Schugart, M.S. and Carey, J. (1992) *Presidents and Assemblies: Constitutional Design and Electoral Dynamics* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) **JF255.SHU**
 - Looks at the effects of constitutional design on electoral laws and regime stability.

SOLO

- Carothers, T. (1999) *Aiding Democracy Abroad* (Washington DC: Carnegie) Ch 7.
 - The importance and difficulties of constitution building in post-conflict societies.

SOLO

- **Lerner, H. (2010) 'Constitution-writing in deeply divided societies: the incrementalist approach', *Nations and Nationalism*, 16(1), 68-88.
 - An extremely interesting study that sheds light on the process of constitutions drafting in India, Israel and Canada.

Online

- Tsebelis, G. (2002) *Veto Players: How Political Institutions Work* (Princeton: Princeton University Press). **JF51.TSE**
 - A very important rational choice analysis of the political system.

SOLO

Economic effects of Constitutions

Economists and others have focused on the short- and long-term impact of constitutions on economic development and economic activity in more general.

- Reynolds, A. ed. (2002) *The Architecture of Democracy: Constitutional Design, Conflict Management and Democracy* (Oxford: Oxford University Press)

SOLO

Online

- Persson, T. and Tabellini, G. (2005) *The Economic Effect of Constitutions* (Cambridge, MA: MIT Press) **K3165.PER**

SOLO

- *Tsebelis, G. and Nardi, D.J. (2014) 'A Long Constitution is a (Positively) Bad Constitution: Evidence from OECD Countries', 1-22.
 - Study finds that rigid constitutions are more likely to be amended and that long constitutions dampen economic growth.

Online

- Prempeh, H.K. (2007) 'Africa's "constitutionalism revival": False start or new dawn?', *Icon-International Journal Of Constitutional Law*, 5(3), 469-506.

Online

- Voigt, S. (1999) *Explaining Constitutional Change – A Positive Economics Approach* (Cheltenham: Edward Elgar) **K3165.VOI**

SOLO

- Elkins, Z., Ginsburg, T. and Melton, J. (2007) 'The Lifespan of Written Constitutions', *University of Illinois, unpublished paper*.

Online

- Elkins, Z., Ginsburg, T. and Melton, J. (2009) *The Endurance of National Constitutions* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press)

SOLO

Online

Case study - Iraq:

- McGarry, J. and O'Leary, B. (2007) 'Iraq's Constitution of 2005: Liberal consociation as political prescription', *International Journal of Constitutional Law*, 5(4), 670-698.
 - Arguably one of the most controversial and momentous acts of constitution writing since the third-wave of democratisation has been Iraq.

Online

Global Constitution Finder:

- The following website has an extensive list of constitutions. It does not include supranational Charters such as the GATT or the UN Charter, which are worth considering as well.

Online

Top

ESSAY GUIDE

Introduction

The purpose of this essay guide is to tackle some of the common problems experienced in writing essays for Comparative Government tutorials and examinations. As well as the fundamental elements of good essay writing, there are specific requirements for this course that will assist students in tutorials and exam preparation. The most important elements are the development of your own argument, and the clarity with which you communicate your ideas.

In addition, it is important to remember that Comparative Government is as much about the *method of comparison* as it is about substantive debates on different topics. In other words there is an important epistemological debate regarding what we *can know* using the comparative method that needs to be recognised in your essays. Using comparison as a method for generating knowledge in political science entails certain important choices that need to be discussed with clarity. The fundamental choices are between different sets of theoretical assumptions, and different approaches to the collection and use of evidence. Clearly theoretical and empirical choices are important in all areas of political science, however in Comparative Government one must be particularly precise because of the difficulty of generating descriptive or causal inferences that apply to more than one case.

This guide has two parts. The first will consider essay technique generally, whilst the second will consider particular guidance that applies to Comparative Government essay writing. Following these two parts will be a printable self-assessment form. During your revision it is recommended that you fill in this form after writing tutorial or mock examination essays. This will help you to understand your strengths and weaknesses in essay writing, allowing you to focus on what needs improving.

Part One – General Points on Good Essay Writing

Before we begin it is important to remember why we write essays. An essay is an act of written communication intended to offer a solution to an intellectual problem or question. Therefore, the most important element of any essay is critical analysis – aka argumentation. In an essay there will be three basic elements:

- a) Narrative – where you describe empirical facts.
- b) Analysis – where you evaluate the importance of those facts.
- c) Argument – where you make a case that your analysis provides the best solution to the problem in hand.

Narrative is important, but it is the easiest element to write and therefore contributes little to your overall mark. Far more important is your analysis and argument. Narrative must be used, but only as a support for your argument. Therefore, do not just list facts or describe what other people have argued. Set out your own argument and use facts and reviews of the literature to defend your position.

This part of the guide will discuss general approaches to essay writing by considering the fundamental questions you should ask yourself.

1. Have I answered the question in the introduction?

First you must be sure that you are answering the question precisely and in its entirety. Second you should set out your answer in your introductory paragraph.

On the first point, it is tempting to answer an essay question by utilising analysis and evidence that you are familiar with, without necessarily being sure of their relevance. Be aware that essay questions are written to test the adaptability of your knowledge and essay writing skill. Therefore, if you answer your own “preferred question,” you leave the examiner in doubt as to whether you understood the question. As the examiners have put it:

“Some candidates would have been advised to take more care to answer the precise question asked rather than using it as an opportunity to regurgitate a detailed knowledge of what was thought to be the underlying topic.”

To avoid this problem, it is critical that you analyse the question and determine what it is trying to ask you. Therefore, you need to be sure that you are answering the question, and answering it in its entirety. Remember, essay questions are difficult so examiners can discriminate between stronger and weaker candidates. The best scripts will adapt what the author knows to the question asked. Here is your new mantra – unlike politicians, political scientists always answer questions!

The second important point to consider is that your answer should be laid out in your introduction. This means that your central argument needs to be summarised fully within the first lines of the essay. Do not tease the examiner by saying that one could argue several points without specifying your central contention. This may seem a blunt and unattractive essay style, but you need to communicate your ideas efficiently because the examiners have limited time to mark your scripts and they will not want to hunt around your essay for your answer. It is not good enough to have a clear conclusion; you must make your case in the introduction and argue it all the way through the essay to the end.

Ensuring that your argument is clearly laid out in the introduction and is consistent throughout the essay requires careful planning. Before you write the essay, you need to know what you are going to say and how the paragraphs connect to form a coherent argument. The importance of good planning is difficult to over-emphasise.

2. Have I defined all of the unclear elements in the question?

A good candidate will always seek to clarify the meaning of key words in exam question, so as to base their argument on a solid foundation. When it comes to the analysis of words or terms, you should be as precise as possible and to show engagement with the literature. In the essay question you must analyse ambiguous noun modifiers, for example:

Party organizations of a traditional kind are no longer needed - either for running election campaigns or for any other purpose.’ Do you agree?

It would not be possible to answer this question unless you defined what ‘party organizations of a traditional kind’ were. In Comparative Government clarity is particularly important because the need to generalise across cases can render meaningless any concept that is too elastic. Clear definitions are therefore important, but semantic analysis should not detain you for long in your essay. A sentence or two is typically sufficient. The key thing to remember is that you are only defining these terms so that your answer to the question is more solidly founded, and you should not be tempted to begin an extensive debate on what ‘traditional’ party organizations are. In some essay questions there are many ambiguous terms employed and definitions can become cumbersome. Nevertheless, be succinct and remember that definitions are a means to the end of creating a clear argument, and not an end in themselves.

It is common for an essay question to introduce a concept that is widely used in the literature, and in these cases a definition taken from a widely respected source from the reading list is a good

approach. Be aware that no conceptualisation is incontestable and you need to accept that at some point a choice must be made as to what a term means so that you can move on to the main point of the essay – answering the question with a clear argument.

3. Do I have a logical structure that is clearly set out in a ‘road map’?

Once again the aim here is clarity of communication. Your essay is a contribution to the academic community and a demonstration that you have done and thought about the reading for the topic. To achieve this, a logical structure is obligatory.

‘Logical’ is somewhat misleading in this context. Essay structure may be ‘logical’ in the colloquial meaning of the word. As in, the structure ‘makes sense’ to your readers. It is not necessary to ensure an essay is ‘logical’ in the more literal sense, albeit the consecutive ordering of predicates leading to a conclusion is a good guide to essay structuring. Essentially you are aiming to organise your essay in a way that is reader-friendly. Therefore, you should have paragraphs that link together to form a coherent whole, and where the movement from one paragraph to the next makes sense and does not jar with the reader.

Perhaps the easiest way to understand logical structure is to understand what it is not. ‘Stream of consciousness’ is the antithesis of a logical structure. This is where the writer does not plan the essay but writes down ideas as they pop into consciousness. This typically manifests as long incoherent paragraphs that jump from one point to the next without any obvious justification.

The best way to avoid this outcome is through careful planning. After you have decided upon your central line of argument you can then decide what the core elements of are and these can form the basic bones of your structural skeleton. To make an argument there for example could be typically three or four separate but connected elements that need to be discussed. If you assign each of these elements a paragraph or two, you can discuss each in turn and build up your whole argument piece by piece.

Breaking your argument into easily comprehensible smaller elements is not always easy to achieve but will always depend on the question and your proposed answer.

Through planning your argument you will determine the content of your separate paragraphs. These paragraphs should be linked together so that the prose develops in a clear way linking to the main argument. The best way to link your paragraphs is by showing how they interconnect to make your argument. It is also worth reiterating your core argument occasionally. This has the advantages of reminding the reader of your central position and also showing that each of your points is relevant to the question. Bridging sentences ensure that your essay flows nicely and that the reader understands how you are developing your argument and how it relates to the question.

The final important point to make is that you must advertise your proposed structure in your introduction so that the examiner knows in advance what your central points are, how they link together, and in what order you intend to analyse them. This is commonly referred to as a ‘road map’, as it helps the reader navigate your essay with ease. This does not need to be any longer than two sentences that signal how the essay will develop.

Good structure is necessary for clear communication of your ideas, and therefore great care should be taken to plan in advance the structure of your essay.

4. Have I balanced my argument?

Your essay must communicate a single argument with clarity, and you certainly should not sit on the fence. However, it is a mistake to analyse only one side of a debate. If you do not make it clear that you have considered alternative explanations then your examiner will assume that you do not know what alternatives there are. Even worse, an examiner may assume that you are incapable of defeating counter-arguments and you have therefore chosen not to mention them.

To avoid this problem you need to explore alternatives to your central thesis. Indeed, it is impossible to argue a strong case without rebutting threats to its validity. Imagine a debater who never acknowledges the points raised by their opponents. The debater appears ignorant. Therefore, for each of your main points you should discuss what your critics would say and show why their solution to the problem at hand is flawed in comparison to your offering. If you can quote existing scholarship, all the better. By doing this you can show the examiner your knowledge of the literature and where your argument fits into it.

Make sure that your voice comes across loud and clear. The examiner wants to know *your* argument, and does not want a narration of the different schools of thought. You need to have the courage to stake your claim with vigour. Never forget that the key skill that is being tested is your ability to analyse a problem in your own words, and thus your argument is the critical element.

Whilst clarity and boldness are important, be sure to avoid a condescending tone when reviewing the literature. The scholars you are critiquing are highly regarded in their field, and to disdain their work is arrogant. The examiner does not want to read a self-righteous rant, so maintain a constructive tone. Your aim should be to write an essay that is persuasive to your fiercest critics. Therefore, a balanced argument does not mean that you are impartial, it means that you understand the literature and you have confidence in your conclusions.

5. *Is my argument original?*

Examiners will usually only consider awarding a first class grade where the script displays independent thought. As the examiners have said:

"...the handful of very strong scripts suggested original and thoughtful responses to the question that moved beyond what they had read."

Developing original arguments is difficult and can backfire. The risk is in creating an argument that is original but ill-thought through and displaying a lack of understanding. To be original you do not need to be radical. Instead you might offer a nuanced development of an existing theory or offer new evidence. That is not to say that you cannot be radical and challenge orthodoxies, just be aware that radicalism is risky and in an exam context it can be difficult to be so innovative within the time constraints.

Nevertheless, you should have the confidence to develop new and creative ideas. Remember, it is *your* ideas and reactions to the readings, in the context of the exam question, that the examiners are interested in. The only reliable means of generating original insights is through hard work. You need to read and understand many of the readings on a given topic and contribute your own insights. Being original is strongly encouraged in all of your essays and exam scripts, but please be sure that your arguments are well defended.

Part Two – Comparative Government Essay Writing

1. Have I clearly outlined my underlying theoretical assumptions?

Your central argument will depend upon certain theoretical assumptions that you have made. It is important to understand and acknowledge the importance of these assumptions to your argument, and you should outline what these assumptions are and why they are justifiable.

There are many gaps in our knowledge of Comparative Government due to the difficulty of developing knowledge that applies to different contexts and through time. These gaps are filled by theoretical assumptions that coalesce what can be observed into a coherent causal or descriptive inference. The fundamental elements of good theory are that it is clear, logical, and falsifiable.

Despite the many labels that are used to describe the different theoretical assumptions within Comparative Government (such as rational choice institutionalism, historical institutionalism, and sociological institutionalism) the schools of thought are not mutually exclusive. All will clearly lay out i) what assumptions they are making, ii) why the assumptions are justifiable, and iii) they will often explain how one could test or disprove their theory. You should do the same in your own essays.

Discussion of your theoretical assumptions need not come in one single place within the essay, and instead can be used to add depth to your critical analysis throughout the essay. That said you should set out the key assumptions that underpin your argument when you introduce your argument.

2. Have I used 'evidence' rather than 'examples'?

This final section is very important and raises a common problem for candidates. In simple terms, evidence is data that supports a proposition, but differs from an example as its validity and reliability have been explained. Also, evidence builds up into a systematic whole, whereas examples are independent illustrations of a phenomenon. You must use a body of evidence whose validity you have explained. As per the examiners:

"As ever, the key skill that divided good from bad answers was good and appropriate use of evidence, with awareness of the basis, reliability and usefulness of particular pieces of evidence to the argument being made."

To ensure you use evidence that coheres to form your argument you may wish to outline your intended sources of evidence in your 'road map'. For instance, you could explain that in order to make your case you will consider data from four industrial democracies in different parts of the world.

This brings up the issue of which types of data to consider. There is a bewildering quantity and variety of evidence that can be rallied in support of your argument. Rather than being intimidated by the choice, you should celebrate the freedom it gives. Indeed, you can use unusual sources of evidence to maximise the originality of your argument. For instance, very few candidates use large-N quantitative data, and yet this is easily available in the articles on the reading list. If you choose to use a small-N qualitative approach then explain why you think that this will produce better results than its alternatives. Consider whether it is better to choose cases that are proximate in time or space, or whether a 'most different systems design' is best. Finally, you need to explain how your evidence knits together to create support for your argument. Once again, the key element is clarity. You should justify your choices, and explain their strengths and weaknesses.

Conclusion

The main point you should take away from this guide is that an essay is a vehicle to communicate critical analysis. It is important to be confident in your abilities and try and enjoy studying government from a comparative perspective. You need to motivate yourself, so work out what you

find interesting and feed your passion. Those who make study and revision more than just a chore will work longer hours and more effectively. There have already been great advances in this paper, and we are confident that progress will continue.

COMPARATIVE GOVERNMENT 201

Self-Assessment

Read through your essay and try and assess your own work by answering the following questions.

Have I answered the question in the introduction?	
Have I defined all of the unclear elements in the question?	
Do I have a logical structure that is clearly set out in a “road map”?	
Have I balanced my argument?	
What evidence do I have to support my contentions?	
Is my argument original?	
Does my conclusion wrap up my argument into a coherent whole?	
What mark would I give this essay and why?	

